

COLONISATION & DECOLONISATION IN THE WORLD

A complete 80-page coursebook in English

Scope

Americas • Africa • Asia •
Middle East • Indian
Ocean

Period

15th century to the
postcolonial world

Skills

Chronology • Comparison
• Source analysis • Essay
writing



Includes 34 lessons, timelines, case studies, thematic diagrams, review exercises and answer guidance.

02 Table of Contents

Lessons 1-17

01 Colonialism, Imperialism and Decolonisation	9-10
02 Early European Overseas Expansion	11-12
03 The Atlantic World and Enslavement	13-14
04 Independence Movements in the Americas	15-16
05 Industrialisation and the New Imperialism	17-18
06 The Berlin Conference and the Scramble for Africa	19-20
07 British Colonial Rule in Africa	21-22
08 French Colonial Rule in Africa	23-24
09 The Congo Free State and Belgian Congo	25-26
10 German, Portuguese and Italian Colonialism in Africa	27-28
11 Colonial Systems of Rule	29-30
12 Colonial Economies: Land, Labour and Taxation	31-32
13 African Resistance and Adaptation	33-34
14 Colonisation of North Africa	35-36
15 British India and the Raj	37-38
16 French Indochina	39-40
17 The Dutch East Indies and the Philippines	41-42

How the book is organised

Every lesson uses a two-page structure: Page A explains the historical framework; Page B develops interpretation, source skills and exam practice.

03 Table of Contents

Lessons 18-34 and review section

18 China and the Age of Imperialism	43-44
19 The Middle East and the Mandate System	45-46
20 Settler Colonialism	47-48
21 Education, Culture, Religion and Colonial Identity	49-50
22 World War I and the Colonial Empires	51-52
23 Interwar Nationalism and Political Organisation	53-54
24 World War II: The Decolonisation Turning Point	55-56
25 India, Pakistan and Partition	57-58
26 Indonesia: Revolution and Sovereignty	59-60
27 Vietnam and the End of French Indochina	61-62
28 Decolonisation in North Africa	63-64
29 Ghana and West African Decolonisation	65-66
30 Kenya and East African Decolonisation	67-68
31 The Congo Crisis	69-70
32 Southern Africa: Liberation and Majority Rule	71-72
33 Madagascar: Colonisation and Independence	73-74
34 The Cold War, Non-Alignment and Colonial Legacies	75-76
Review Test	77
Essay & Source Practice	78
Answer & Marking Guide	79
Master Reference Timeline	80

04 How to Use This Coursebook

Study method and exam skills

How to study each lesson

1. Read the overview once for the main argument.
2. Learn the key terms before memorising dates.
3. Use the timeline to place events in sequence.
4. Ask how political, economic, social and international factors interacted.
5. Answer the checkpoint questions without looking back.

Four historical skills

- **Chronology:** put developments in order and identify turning points.
- **Causation:** explain why events happened and rank interacting causes.
- **Comparison:** identify similarities and differences between cases.
- **Interpretation:** distinguish evidence from later historical judgement.

Suggested essay structure

Introduction

Define the question, period and argument.

Body paragraphs

One clear factor per paragraph, supported by specific evidence.

Comparison

Weigh factors instead of listing them.

Conclusion

Answer the exact question and explain the relative importance of causes.

Important: Colonial history involves violence, slavery, racism and political conflict. Use precise language, distinguish documented facts from disputed estimates, and avoid treating colonised societies as passive.

05 Master Chronology

From early empire to the postcolonial era

1492-1600	Atlantic expansion and conquest
1600-1800	Chartered companies, plantation empires, slavery
1776-1825	Major American independence movements
1830-1870	Early territorial conquest in Africa and Asia
1870-1914	New Imperialism and Scramble for Africa
1914-1919	World War I and mandate system
1919-1939	Interwar nationalism
1939-1945	World War II weakens empires
1945-1960	Asian independence and first major African wave
1960	Year of Africa
1960s-1970s	Wars of liberation and late empire
1980-1990	Zimbabwe and Namibia complete major African decolonisation phase

Reading the chronology: Decolonisation was not a single event beginning in 1945. The Americas experienced major independence movements much earlier, while some African territories remained under colonial or minority rule until the late twentieth century.

06 Core Vocabulary

Essential concepts for the entire course

Colonialism

Direct political control over another territory and population.

Imperialism

Extension of power through political, military, economic or cultural means.

Protectorate

A territory with a local ruler but decisive external control over key affairs.

Mandate

Territory administered under League of Nations supervision after World War I.

Settler colonialism

Colonialism involving permanent settlement and control over land.

Assimilation

Policy claiming that colonial subjects could adopt the coloniser's institutions and culture.

Indirect rule

Administration through recognised local authorities.

Nationalism

Political identification with a nation and demand for collective sovereignty.

Self-determination

Principle that peoples should determine their own political status.

Sovereignty

Supreme political authority within a territory.

Decolonisation

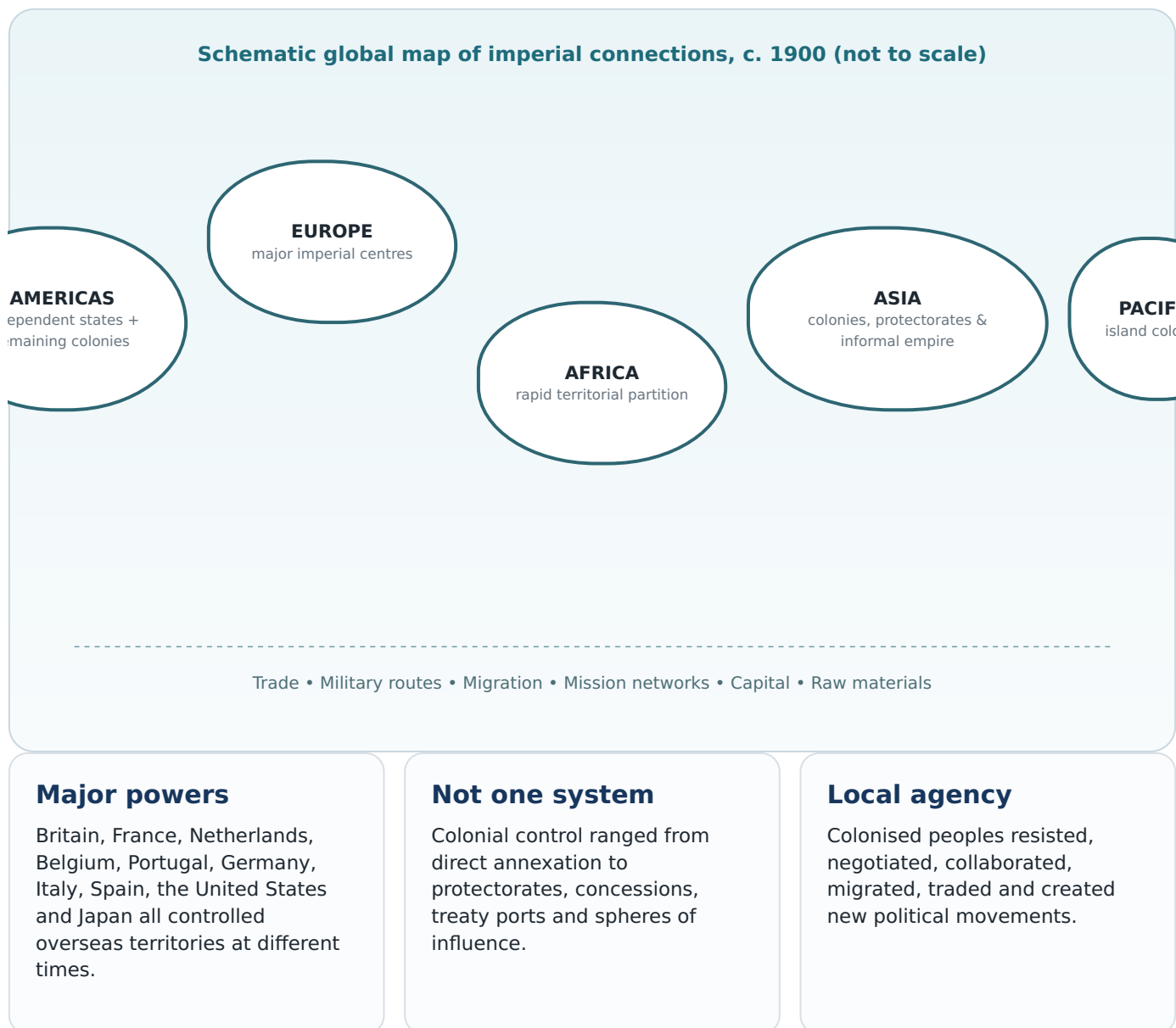
Dismantling formal colonial rule and establishing sovereignty.

Neo-colonialism

Continuing external influence after formal independence, especially economic or strategic.

07 The World of Empire

A thematic map for orientation



08 How to Analyse Historical Sources

Evidence, perspective and reliability

OPVL source method

Origin: Who created the source, where and when?

Purpose: Why was it created, and for which audience?

Value: What can it reveal because of its origin and purpose?

Limitation: What can it not tell us, or what bias may shape it?

Questions for colonial sources

- Does the source use racial or paternalistic language?
- Who is speaking and who is silent?
- Does it describe policy or actual practice?
- What local evidence could confirm or challenge it?
- Is the source contemporary or a later memory?

Mini practice

"The railway will bring progress to the territory and connect productive districts to the coast."

Analysis: The statement may accurately describe infrastructure expansion, but it also reflects an official development viewpoint. A historian should ask who paid for construction, who supplied labour, which districts were connected, what goods were transported, and whether local communities benefited equally.

Rule: A source can be biased and still be historically valuable. Bias itself can reveal political assumptions, interests and fears.

09 Colonialism, Imperialism and Decolonisation

Lesson 1: explanation, chronology and key concepts

LESSON 01

Concepts and historical framework

Historical overview

Colonialism is the establishment of political control over another territory, often accompanied by settlement, economic extraction and cultural domination. Imperialism is broader: it refers to the extension of power through political, military, economic or cultural influence. Decolonisation is the process through which colonies obtain sovereignty and dismantle formal imperial rule. These processes did not occur in one place or at one time. They developed over centuries and took different forms in the Americas, Africa, Asia, the Middle East and the Pacific.

Key ideas

- Distinguish empire, colony, protectorate, mandate and sphere of influence.
- Formal political rule could coexist with informal economic domination.
- Decolonisation could be negotiated, revolutionary, gradual or violent.
- Independence did not automatically remove colonial economic and cultural structures.

Key terms

colony empire imperialism
protectorate self-determination
sovereignty

Why this lesson matters

A useful way to study empire is to separate political sovereignty from economic power. A territory could become legally independent while remaining strongly tied to former colonial markets, currencies, companies or military networks.

Date / period	Development
15th-18th c.	European overseas empires expand
c. 1800-1914	Industrial-era imperialism grows
1914-1945	World wars weaken old empires
1945-1975	Main wave of Asian and African decolonisation
1975-1990	Late decolonisation in southern Africa

Checkpoint

1. Why is imperialism a broader concept than colonialism?
2. Give two different forms that decolonisation could take.

10 Colonialism, Imperialism and Decolonisation

Lesson 1: case study, comparison and exam practice

LESSON 01 • ANALYSIS

Concepts and historical framework

Case study focus

A useful way to study empire is to separate political sovereignty from economic power. A territory could become legally independent while remaining strongly tied to former colonial markets, currencies, companies or military networks.

Main consequences

- New borders and states
- Long-term changes in trade and land ownership
- Cultural exchange and cultural suppression
- Nationalist movements and new political identities

Comparative thinking

Compare political control with economic influence. Ask who made decisions, who owned land or capital, who paid taxes, and which groups gained or lost power. Early empire often depended on coastal networks before becoming territorial rule.

Source-analysis lens

A useful source set could combine a travel account, a trading-company record and the testimony of a colonised or enslaved person. Compare purpose, audience and silence: what does each source fail to tell us?

Political

Who controlled the state, law, army and representation?

Economic

Who controlled land, labour, taxation, trade and resources?

Social

How were communities, education, migration and identity affected?

International

How did war, diplomacy or external powers shape the outcome?

Exam practice

Short response: Why can political independence be different from economic independence?

Extended writing: "The most important cause of change in this topic was political pressure from colonised peoples." Discuss this statement using specific evidence from the lesson.

Source task: Identify one source that could support the argument and one source that could challenge it. Explain why.

Memory line: Colonialism, Imperialism and Decolonisation — connect *cause* → *method of control/resistance* → *turning point* → *consequence*.

11 Early European Overseas Expansion

Lesson 2: explanation, chronology and key concepts

LESSON 02

15th to 18th centuries

Historical overview

From the late fifteenth century, Portuguese and Spanish voyages linked Europe more directly to Africa, Asia and the Americas. Maritime technologies, commercial ambitions, missionary activity and interstate rivalry encouraged overseas expansion. Portugal built trading posts along African and Asian coasts, while Spain conquered large American empires. Later, Dutch, British and French companies and states created competing networks. Early modern empires relied heavily on shipping, fortified ports, chartered companies, plantation production and coerced labour.

Key ideas

- Oceanic navigation connected previously separate regional trade systems.
- Conquest, alliances and disease reshaped societies in the Americas.
- Chartered companies mixed private commerce with state power.
- Control was often strongest at ports and trade routes before expanding inland.

Key terms

chartered company conquistador
plantation mercantilism missionary
trading post

Why this lesson matters

European power was never based on ships alone. Local alliances, existing rivalries, access to knowledge and control of commercial chokepoints often mattered as much as weapons. Many Asian states remained powerful for centuries despite European coastal presence.

Date / period	Development
1492	Columbus reaches the Caribbean
1498	Vasco da Gama reaches India by sea
1600	English East India Company chartered
1602	Dutch East India Company created
17th-18th c.	European competition intensifies

Checkpoint

1. What were the main motives for early overseas expansion?
2. Why were trading posts important?

12 Early European Overseas Expansion

Lesson 2: case study, comparison and exam practice

LESSON 02 • ANALYSIS

15th to 18th centuries

Case study focus

European power was never based on ships alone. Local alliances, existing rivalries, access to knowledge and control of commercial chokepoints often mattered as much as weapons. Many Asian states remained powerful for centuries despite European coastal presence.

Main consequences

- Global maritime trade
- Colonial conquest in the Americas
- Expansion of missionary networks
- Growth of plantation economies

Comparative thinking

Compare political control with economic influence. Ask who made decisions, who owned land or capital, who paid taxes, and which groups gained or lost power. Early empire often depended on coastal networks before becoming territorial rule.

Source-analysis lens

A useful source set could combine a travel account, a trading-company record and the testimony of a colonised or enslaved person. Compare purpose, audience and silence: what does each source fail to tell us?

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Who controlled the state, law, army and representation?

Economic

Who controlled land, labour, taxation, trade and resources?

Social

How were communities, education, migration and identity affected?

International

How did war, diplomacy or external powers shape the outcome?

Exam practice

Short response: How did private companies become instruments of empire?

Extended writing: "The most important cause of change in this topic was political pressure from colonised peoples." Discuss this statement using specific evidence from the lesson.

Source task: Identify one source that could support the argument and one source that could challenge it. Explain why.

Memory line: Early European Overseas Expansion — connect *cause* → *method of control/resistance* → *turning point* → *consequence*.

13 The Atlantic World and Enslavement

Lesson 3: explanation, chronology and key concepts

LESSON 03

16th to 19th centuries

Historical overview

European colonisation of the Americas became deeply connected to the forced migration of enslaved Africans. Plantation economies producing sugar, tobacco, cotton and other commodities generated enormous profits while relying on brutal systems of coercion. African societies were affected unevenly: some rulers and merchants participated in slave trading, while many communities suffered warfare, raids, demographic loss and political disruption. Enslaved people resisted through escape, revolt, cultural survival, family formation and everyday acts of refusal.

Key ideas

- The Atlantic slave trade linked European, African and American economies.
- Plantation slavery was central to several colonial economies.
- Resistance by enslaved people took many forms.
- Abolition was gradual and did not immediately produce social equality.

Key terms

Middle Passage

abolition

plantation slavery

diaspora

emancipation

resistance

Why this lesson matters

The Haitian Revolution was both an anti-slavery revolution and a struggle against colonial rule. Enslaved and free people in Saint-Domingue defeated attempts to restore the old order and created independent Haiti in 1804.

Date / period	Development
16th c.	Large-scale Atlantic slave trade expands
1791-1804	Haitian Revolution
1807	Britain bans its slave trade
1833	Slavery abolished in most British colonies
1888	Brazil abolishes slavery

Checkpoint

1. How did slavery support colonial economies?
2. Why is Haiti important in the history of decolonisation?

14 The Atlantic World and Enslavement

Lesson 3: case study, comparison and exam practice

LESSON 03 • ANALYSIS

16th to 19th centuries

Case study focus

The Haitian Revolution was both an anti-slavery revolution and a struggle against colonial rule. Enslaved and free people in Saint-Domingue defeated attempts to restore the old order and created independent Haiti in 1804.

Main consequences

- Forced migration on a vast scale
- Racial hierarchies embedded in law and society
- Wealth accumulation in Atlantic economies
- Long-lasting African and diaspora cultural connections

Comparative thinking

Compare political control with economic influence. Ask who made decisions, who owned land or capital, who paid taxes, and which groups gained or lost power. Early empire often depended on coastal networks before becoming territorial rule.

Source-analysis lens

A useful source set could combine a travel account, a trading-company record and the testimony of a colonised or enslaved person. Compare purpose, audience and silence: what does each source fail to tell us?

Political

Who controlled the state, law, army and representation?

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Who controlled land, labour, taxation, trade and resources?

Social

How were communities, education, migration and identity affected?

International

How did war, diplomacy or external powers shape the outcome?

Exam practice

Short response: What forms could resistance take?

Extended writing: "The most important cause of change in this topic was political pressure from colonised peoples." Discuss this statement using specific evidence from the lesson.

Source task: Identify one source that could support the argument and one source that could challenge it. Explain why.

Memory line: The Atlantic World and Enslavement — connect *cause* → *method of control/resistance* → *turning point* → *consequence*.

15 Independence Movements in the Americas

Lesson 4: explanation, chronology and key concepts

LESSON 04

Late 18th to 19th centuries

Historical overview

The first major wave of modern decolonisation took place in the Americas. The United States declared independence from Britain in 1776, Haiti became independent from France in 1804, and most Spanish American colonies won independence during the early nineteenth century. Brazil separated from Portugal in 1822. These movements were influenced by Enlightenment ideas, local political conflicts, economic grievances and wars in Europe. However, independence often preserved deep inequalities related to race, class, land ownership and slavery.

Key ideas

- Political independence in the Americas preceded Asian and African decolonisation.
- Creole elites often led Spanish American independence movements.
- Haiti uniquely combined anti-colonial revolution with the destruction of slavery.
- New states faced problems of borders, legitimacy and social inequality.

Key terms

creole republic independence
revolution emancipation caudillo

Why this lesson matters

Simón Bolívar imagined political cooperation among newly independent Spanish American republics, but regional interests and internal divisions made lasting continental unity difficult.

Date / period	Development
1776	US Declaration of Independence
1804	Haitian independence
1810s-1820s	Spanish American independence wars
1822	Brazil declares independence
1898	Spanish rule ends in Cuba after war with the United States

Checkpoint

1. Why can American independence be considered decolonisation?
2. What made Haiti different from many other independence movements?

16 Independence Movements in the Americas

Lesson 4: case study, comparison and exam practice

LESSON 04 • ANALYSIS

Late 18th to 19th centuries

Case study focus

Simón Bolívar imagined political cooperation among newly independent Spanish American republics, but regional interests and internal divisions made lasting continental unity difficult.

Main consequences

- End of much European rule in the Americas
- Creation of new republics and monarchies
- Persistence of unequal land systems
- New forms of foreign economic influence

Comparative thinking

Compare political control with economic influence. Ask who made decisions, who owned land or capital, who paid taxes, and which groups gained or lost power. Early empire often depended on coastal networks before becoming territorial rule.

Source-analysis lens

A useful source set could combine a travel account, a trading-company record and the testimony of a colonised or enslaved person. Compare purpose, audience and silence: what does each source fail to tell us?

Political

Who controlled the state, law, army and representation?

Economic

Who controlled land, labour, taxation, trade and resources?

Social

How were communities, education, migration and identity affected?

International

How did war, diplomacy or external powers shape the outcome?

Exam practice

Short response: Which inequalities continued after independence?

Extended writing: “The most important cause of change in this topic was political pressure from colonised peoples.” Discuss this statement using specific evidence from the lesson.

Source task: Identify one source that could support the argument and one source that could challenge it. Explain why.

Memory line: Independence Movements in the Americas — connect *cause* → *method of control/resistance* → *turning point* → *consequence*.

17 Industrialisation and the New Imperialism

Lesson 5: explanation, chronology and key concepts

LESSON 05

c. 1870-1914

Historical overview

During the late nineteenth century, European imperial expansion accelerated dramatically. Industrial economies sought raw materials, markets, investment opportunities and strategic routes. National prestige and rivalry also mattered, while missionaries, explorers and racial ideologies were used to justify intervention. Steamships, railways, telegraphs and modern weapons increased the capacity of imperial states to project power. Yet conquest still depended on local allies, administrative compromises and the ability to finance occupation.

Key ideas

- Industrial technology changed the scale and speed of imperial expansion.
- Economic motives interacted with strategic and political competition.
- Racial theories and the so-called civilising mission legitimised domination.
- Imperial conquest was often met by organised resistance.

Key terms

New Imperialism

industrialisation

strategic route

raw materials

civilising mission

gunboat diplomacy

Why this lesson matters

The Suez Canal became strategically important because it shortened the sea route between Europe and Asia. British control over Egypt from 1882 was closely linked to protecting this route and imperial communications with India.

Date / period	Development
1869	Suez Canal opens
1870s	New imperial competition accelerates
1884-1885	Berlin Conference
1898	Fashoda crisis reflects imperial rivalry
1914	European empires reach maximum territorial extent

Checkpoint

1. How did industrialisation facilitate imperialism?
2. Why was the Suez Canal strategically important?

18 Industrialisation and the New Imperialism

Lesson 5: case study, comparison and exam practice

LESSON 05 • ANALYSIS

c. 1870-1914

Case study focus

The Suez Canal became strategically important because it shortened the sea route between Europe and Asia. British control over Egypt from 1882 was closely linked to protecting this route and imperial communications with India.

Main consequences

- Rapid conquest of African territories
- Infrastructure built for administration and export
- Expansion of colonial taxation
- Intensified rivalries among imperial powers

Comparative thinking

Compare political control with economic influence. Ask who made decisions, who owned land or capital, who paid taxes, and which groups gained or lost power. Early empire often depended on coastal networks before becoming territorial rule.

Source-analysis lens

A useful source set could combine a travel account, a trading-company record and the testimony of a colonised or enslaved person. Compare purpose, audience and silence: what does each source fail to tell us?

Political

Who controlled the state, law, army and representation?

Economic

Who controlled land, labour, taxation, trade and resources?

Social

How were communities, education, migration and identity affected?

International

How did war, diplomacy or external powers shape the outcome?

Exam practice

Short response: Why should economic explanations not be used alone?

Extended writing: "The most important cause of change in this topic was political pressure from colonised peoples." Discuss this statement using specific evidence from the lesson.

Source task: Identify one source that could support the argument and one source that could challenge it. Explain why.

Memory line: Industrialisation and the New Imperialism — connect *cause* → *method of control/resistance* → *turning point* → *consequence*.

19 The Berlin Conference and the Scramble for Africa

Lesson 6: explanation, chronology and key concepts

LESSON 06

1884-1914

Historical overview

The Berlin Conference of 1884-1885 did not literally divide every African territory on a map, but it established rules among European powers for recognising colonial claims, especially the principle of effective occupation. In the following decades, European states rapidly conquered most of Africa. African rulers and societies responded through diplomacy, military resistance, accommodation and alliance-building. By 1914, Ethiopia and Liberia were the principal African states that remained formally independent, though Ethiopia later faced Italian occupation in the 1930s.

Key ideas

- European diplomatic rules helped reduce conflict among colonising states.
- African borders often ignored or cut across existing political and social regions.
- Conquest required military campaigns and local collaboration.
- The Scramble was rapid but not uncontested.

Key terms

Scramble for Africa effective occupation
partition Adwa boundary
concession

Why this lesson matters

The victory of Ethiopia at Adwa in 1896 showed that European conquest was not inevitable. Emperor Menelik II combined diplomacy, weapons acquisition and mobilisation to defeat an Italian invasion.

Date / period	Development
1884-1885	Berlin Conference
1885	Congo Free State internationally recognised
1890s	Major colonial wars across Africa
1896	Ethiopia defeats Italy at Adwa
1914	Most of Africa under colonial rule

Checkpoint

1. What did the Berlin Conference actually regulate?
2. Why is Adwa historically significant?

20 The Berlin Conference and the Scramble for Africa

Lesson 6: case study, comparison and exam practice

LESSON 06 • ANALYSIS

1884-1914

Case study focus

The victory of Ethiopia at Adwa in 1896 showed that European conquest was not inevitable. Emperor Menelik II combined diplomacy, weapons acquisition and mobilisation to defeat an Italian invasion.

Main consequences

- New colonial borders
- Military occupation
- Competition over rivers and trade routes
- Formation of colonial states with limited African political participation

Comparative thinking

Compare political control with economic influence. Ask who made decisions, who owned land or capital, who paid taxes, and which groups gained or lost power. Early empire often depended on coastal networks before becoming territorial rule.

Source-analysis lens

A useful source set could combine a travel account, a trading-company record and the testimony of a colonised or enslaved person. Compare purpose, audience and silence: what does each source fail to tell us?

Political

Who controlled the state, law, army and representation?

Economic

Who controlled land, labour, taxation, trade and resources?

Social

How were communities, education, migration and identity affected?

International

How did war, diplomacy or external powers shape the outcome?

Exam practice

Short response: How could colonial borders create later political problems?

Extended writing: "The most important cause of change in this topic was political pressure from colonised peoples." Discuss this statement using specific evidence from the lesson.

Source task: Identify one source that could support the argument and one source that could challenge it. Explain why.

Memory line: The Berlin Conference and the Scramble for Africa — connect *cause* → *method of control/resistance* → *turning point* → *consequence*.

21 British Colonial Rule in Africa

Lesson 7: explanation, chronology and key concepts

LESSON 07

19th to 20th centuries

Historical overview

Britain controlled territories across West, East, central and southern Africa, but it did not use one single administrative system everywhere. Indirect rule often governed through recognised chiefs or local authorities, especially where officials were few. In settler colonies, land alienation and racial inequality could be much stronger. British colonial economies promoted export crops, mining, railways and taxation. Political participation for Africans remained limited for much of the colonial period.

Key ideas

- Indirect rule varied significantly from place to place.
- Railways often linked mines or farming zones to ports rather than integrating local economies.
- Taxation encouraged participation in wage labour and cash-crop production.
- Colonial rule changed and sometimes invented chiefly authority.

Key terms

indirect rule chief cash crop
settler colony colonial service
protectorate

Why this lesson matters

In Nigeria, British officials used indirect rule but encountered very different political systems. Institutions that worked in some northern emirates could not simply be transferred to societies without comparable centralised chieftaincy.

Date / period	Development
1882	British occupation of Egypt
1890s	Expansion in East and West Africa
1910	Union of South Africa created
1920s-1930s	Colonial administration consolidated
1950s-1960s	Most British African colonies become independent

Checkpoint

1. What was indirect rule?
2. Why did it work differently across regions?

22 British Colonial Rule in Africa

Lesson 7: case study, comparison and exam practice

LESSON 07 • ANALYSIS

19th to 20th centuries

Case study focus

In Nigeria, British officials used indirect rule but encountered very different political systems. Institutions that worked in some northern emirates could not simply be transferred to societies without comparable centralised chieftaincy.

Main consequences

- Expansion of export agriculture
- New administrative hierarchies
- Unequal access to land and education
- Growth of nationalist organisations

Comparative thinking

Compare the official ideology of colonial rule with everyday practice. Administrations spoke of order, development or civilisation, but budgets, labour demands, land policies and policing reveal how rule actually operated.

Source-analysis lens

Use colonial reports carefully. They provide valuable administrative detail, but officials often described resistance as disorder. Read them alongside oral traditions, African newspapers, petitions and later historical research.

Political

Who controlled the state, law, army and representation?

Economic

Who controlled land, labour, taxation, trade and resources?

Social

How were communities, education, migration and identity affected?

International

How did war, diplomacy or external powers shape the outcome?

Exam practice

Short response: How did taxation reshape colonial economies?

Extended writing: “The most important cause of change in this topic was political pressure from colonised peoples.” Discuss this statement using specific evidence from the lesson.

Source task: Identify one source that could support the argument and one source that could challenge it. Explain why.

Memory line: British Colonial Rule in Africa — connect *cause* → *method of control/resistance* → *turning point* → *consequence*.

23 French Colonial Rule in Africa

Lesson 8: explanation, chronology and key concepts

LESSON 08

19th to 20th centuries

Historical overview

France created large federations in West and Equatorial Africa and also ruled territories in North Africa and the Indian Ocean. French colonial ideology often spoke of assimilation, suggesting that colonial subjects could adopt French language and institutions. In practice, full political equality was rare. Policies later shifted toward association, which accepted more local difference while preserving French authority. Forced labour, taxation, military recruitment and cash-crop production were important features in several territories.

Key ideas

- Assimilation was an ideal applied unevenly and selectively.
- Association recognised local institutions without surrendering colonial control.
- French language and schooling became important tools of administration.
- Colonial subjects often demanded that France apply its own principles of citizenship and equality.

Key terms

assimilation

association

French Union

citizenship

indigénat

federation

Why this lesson matters

The Four Communes of Senegal had unusual political rights compared with most French African territories. Their special status demonstrates how French citizenship policies could differ sharply within the empire.

Date / period	Development
1830	French conquest of Algeria begins
1895	French West Africa federation formed
1910	French Equatorial Africa federation formed
1946	French Union established
1958-1960	Most sub-Saharan French colonies move to independence

Checkpoint

1. How did assimilation differ from association?
2. Why was full equality limited?

24 French Colonial Rule in Africa

Lesson 8: case study, comparison and exam practice

LESSON 08 • ANALYSIS

19th to 20th centuries

Case study focus

The Four Communes of Senegal had unusual political rights compared with most French African territories. Their special status demonstrates how French citizenship policies could differ sharply within the empire.

Main consequences

- French-language education
- Centralised administration
- Military recruitment
- Emergence of political elites who later led independence movements

Comparative thinking

Compare the official ideology of colonial rule with everyday practice. Administrations spoke of order, development or civilisation, but budgets, labour demands, land policies and policing reveal how rule actually operated.

Source-analysis lens

Use colonial reports carefully. They provide valuable administrative detail, but officials often described resistance as disorder. Read them alongside oral traditions, African newspapers, petitions and later historical research.

Political

Who controlled the state, law, army and representation?

Economic

Who controlled land, labour, taxation, trade and resources?

Social

How were communities, education, migration and identity affected?

International

How did war, diplomacy or external powers shape the outcome?

Exam practice

Short response: How could colonial education contribute to nationalism?

Extended writing: "The most important cause of change in this topic was political pressure from colonised peoples." Discuss this statement using specific evidence from the lesson.

Source task: Identify one source that could support the argument and one source that could challenge it. Explain why.

Memory line: French Colonial Rule in Africa — connect *cause* → *method of control/resistance* → *turning point* → *consequence*.

25 The Congo Free State and Belgian Congo

Lesson 9: explanation, chronology and key concepts

LESSON 09

1885-1960

Historical overview

The Congo Free State was initially the personal domain of King Leopold II of Belgium rather than a Belgian state colony. Concession companies and officials extracted rubber and ivory through coercive systems that caused severe violence, displacement and population loss. International criticism eventually forced Belgium to annex the territory in 1908. Under Belgian colonial rule, mining and infrastructure expanded, but political participation and higher education for Congolese people remained extremely restricted until late in the colonial period.

Key ideas

- Private imperial ownership could be as coercive as state colonialism.
- Rubber extraction became associated with forced labour and severe punishment.
- International humanitarian campaigns influenced policy but did not end colonial rule.
- Very limited political preparation contributed to difficulties at independence.

Key terms

concession company

forced labour

rubber

Leopold II

Belgian Congo

resource extraction

Why this lesson matters

The Congo Reform movement used missionary testimony, photographs, reports and political campaigning to expose abuses. It is an early example of transnational activism directed against colonial violence.

Date / period	Development
1885	Congo Free State recognised
1890s-1900s	Rubber extraction and atrocities draw criticism
1908	Belgium annexes the Congo
1950s	Nationalist politics grows rapidly
30 June 1960	Congo becomes independent

Checkpoint

1. Why was the Congo Free State unusual?
2. How did international criticism matter?

26 The Congo Free State and Belgian Congo

Lesson 9: case study, comparison and exam practice

LESSON 09 • ANALYSIS

1885-1960

Case study focus

The Congo Reform movement used missionary testimony, photographs, reports and political campaigning to expose abuses. It is an early example of transnational activism directed against colonial violence.

Main consequences

- Mining-oriented economy
- Severe coercion and demographic disruption
- Weak development of representative institutions
- Post-independence struggles over state authority and resources

Comparative thinking

Compare the official ideology of colonial rule with everyday practice. Administrations spoke of order, development or civilisation, but budgets, labour demands, land policies and policing reveal how rule actually operated.

Source-analysis lens

Use colonial reports carefully. They provide valuable administrative detail, but officials often described resistance as disorder. Read them alongside oral traditions, African newspapers, petitions and later historical research.

Political

Who controlled the state, law, army and representation?

Economic

Who controlled land, labour, taxation, trade and resources?

Social

How were communities, education, migration and identity affected?

International

How did war, diplomacy or external powers shape the outcome?

Exam practice

Short response: What institutional weaknesses existed by 1960?

Extended writing: "The most important cause of change in this topic was political pressure from colonised peoples." Discuss this statement using specific evidence from the lesson.

Source task: Identify one source that could support the argument and one source that could challenge it. Explain why.

Memory line: The Congo Free State and Belgian Congo — connect *cause* → *method of control/resistance* → *turning point* → *consequence*.

27 German, Portuguese and Italian Colonialism in Africa

Lesson 10: explanation, chronology and key concepts

LESSON 10

Late 19th to 20th centuries

Historical overview

Germany, Portugal and Italy controlled smaller African empires than Britain or France, but their rule had major consequences. German colonies included German East Africa, South West Africa, Cameroon and Togo until World War I. Portuguese rule lasted much longer in Angola, Mozambique and other territories. Italy ruled Eritrea and Somalia, conquered Libya, and occupied Ethiopia from 1936 to 1941. Colonial systems involved labour coercion, settler projects and military repression to different degrees.

Key ideas

- Germany lost its colonies after World War I.
- The Herero and Nama genocide occurred under German colonial rule in South West Africa.
- Portuguese decolonisation accelerated after the 1974 Carnation Revolution.
- Italian expansion faced major African resistance, especially Ethiopia.

Key terms

Herero

Nama

Lusophone Africa

settler

mandate

anti-colonial war

Why this lesson matters

In German South West Africa, colonial war against the Herero and Nama escalated into genocide, including expulsions, killings, detention and forced labour. The case is central to debates about colonial violence and historical responsibility.

Date / period	Development
1884-1885	German African empire established
1904-1908	Herero and Nama genocide
1911	Italy conquers Libya from the Ottoman Empire
1936	Italy occupies Ethiopia
1974-1975	Portuguese empire in Africa collapses

Checkpoint

1. Why did German colonial rule end after World War I?
2. What made Portuguese decolonisation relatively late?

28 German, Portuguese and Italian Colonialism in Africa

Lesson 10: case study, comparison and exam practice

LESSON 10 • ANALYSIS

Late 19th to 20th centuries

Case study focus

In German South West Africa, colonial war against the Herero and Nama escalated into genocide, including expulsions, killings, detention and forced labour. The case is central to debates about colonial violence and historical responsibility.

Main consequences

- Violent military campaigns
- Long-lasting land inequality
- Forced labour systems
- Late and conflict-ridden decolonisation in Portuguese Africa

Comparative thinking

Compare the official ideology of colonial rule with everyday practice. Administrations spoke of order, development or civilisation, but budgets, labour demands, land policies and policing reveal how rule actually operated.

Source-analysis lens

Use colonial reports carefully. They provide valuable administrative detail, but officials often described resistance as disorder. Read them alongside oral traditions, African newspapers, petitions and later historical research.

Political

Who controlled the state, law, army and representation?

Economic

Who controlled land, labour, taxation, trade and resources?

Social

How were communities, education, migration and identity affected?

International

How did war, diplomacy or external powers shape the outcome?

Exam practice

Short response: Why is Ethiopia important in the history of Italian imperialism?

Extended writing: "The most important cause of change in this topic was political pressure from colonised peoples." Discuss this statement using specific evidence from the lesson.

Source task: Identify one source that could support the argument and one source that could challenge it. Explain why.

Memory line: German, Portuguese and Italian Colonialism in Africa — connect *cause* → *method of control/resistance* → *turning point* → *consequence*.

29 Colonial Systems of Rule

Lesson 11: explanation, chronology and key concepts

LESSON 11

Comparative structures

Historical overview

Colonial governments used many administrative models. Direct rule placed European officials at the centre of government. Indirect rule governed through selected local authorities. Protectorates preserved a formal local ruler while the imperial power controlled key decisions. Mandates and trusteeships claimed to prepare territories for self-government while still placing them under outside authority. In practice, these categories often overlapped, and policies changed as colonial regimes responded to local resistance, costs and political pressure.

Key ideas

- Administrative labels do not fully describe how power worked on the ground.
- Colonial states were often thinly staffed and relied on intermediaries.
- Customary law could be reshaped by colonial administrators.
- Legal systems frequently created unequal categories of citizenship.

Key terms

direct rule indirect rule protectorate
mandate trusteeship customary law

Why this lesson matters

A colonial state could present a chief as the representative of 'tradition' even where political authority had previously been more dispersed. This shows that colonialism sometimes invented or hardened social categories rather than merely preserving them.

Date / period	Development
19th c.	Direct and indirect systems develop
1919	League of Nations mandates established
1945	UN trusteeship system created
1940s-1960s	Constitutional reforms expand representation
Post-independence	Many administrative institutions are retained

Checkpoint

1. Compare direct and indirect rule.
2. Why did colonial states rely on intermediaries?

30 Colonial Systems of Rule

Lesson 11: case study, comparison and exam practice

LESSON 11 • ANALYSIS

Comparative structures

Case study focus

A colonial state could present a chief as the representative of 'tradition' even where political authority had previously been more dispersed. This shows that colonialism sometimes invented or hardened social categories rather than merely preserving them.

Main consequences

- Centralised bureaucracies
- Legal dualism
- Creation or reinforcement of ethnic categories
- Administrative continuity after independence

Comparative thinking

Compare the official ideology of colonial rule with everyday practice. Administrations spoke of order, development or civilisation, but budgets, labour demands, land policies and policing reveal how rule actually operated.

Source-analysis lens

Use colonial reports carefully. They provide valuable administrative detail, but officials often described resistance as disorder. Read them alongside oral traditions, African newspapers, petitions and later historical research.

Political

Who controlled the state, law, army and representation?

Economic

Who controlled land, labour, taxation, trade and resources?

Social

How were communities, education, migration and identity affected?

International

How did war, diplomacy or external powers shape the outcome?

Exam practice

Short response: How could colonial rule transform customary authority?

Extended writing: "The most important cause of change in this topic was political pressure from colonised peoples." Discuss this statement using specific evidence from the lesson.

Source task: Identify one source that could support the argument and one source that could challenge it. Explain why.

Memory line: Colonial Systems of Rule — connect *cause* → *method of control/resistance* → *turning point* → *consequence*.

31 Colonial Economies: Land, Labour and Taxation

Lesson 12: explanation, chronology and key concepts

LESSON 12

19th to 20th centuries

Historical overview

Colonial economies were reorganised to serve a mixture of local, imperial and global interests. Governments encouraged or compelled production of export crops such as cocoa, coffee, cotton, rubber and groundnuts. Mining expanded in resource-rich regions. Taxes payable in money pushed households toward wage labour or market production. In settler colonies, land could be transferred to European farmers, reducing African access to fertile areas. Infrastructure was often designed to move exports from producing zones to ports.

Key ideas

- Colonial economies were not identical, but many became export-oriented.
- Taxation changed labour patterns and household strategies.
- Mining zones attracted migrants and created new urban centres.
- Colonial infrastructure could support growth while also reinforcing extraction.

Key terms

cash crop hut tax migrant labour
concession export economy commodity

Why this lesson matters

Cocoa production in the Gold Coast was driven substantially by African farmers rather than only by European plantations. This reminds us that colonial economies included African entrepreneurship as well as coercion.

Date / period	Development
Late 19th c.	Cash-crop and mining systems expand
1900s-1930s	Rail and port networks grow
1930s	Global depression disrupts commodity prices
1940s-1950s	Development planning increases
Post-1960	Many states remain dependent on a small range of exports

Checkpoint

- Why were taxes important to colonial labour systems?
- How did railways reflect export priorities?

32 Colonial Economies: Land, Labour and Taxation

Lesson 12: case study, comparison and exam practice

LESSON 12 • ANALYSIS

19th to 20th centuries

Case study focus

Cocoa production in the Gold Coast was driven substantially by African farmers rather than only by European plantations. This reminds us that colonial economies included African entrepreneurship as well as coercion.

Main consequences

- Commodity dependence
- Labour migration
- Urbanisation
- Land disputes and rural inequality

Comparative thinking

Compare the official ideology of colonial rule with everyday practice. Administrations spoke of order, development or civilisation, but budgets, labour demands, land policies and policing reveal how rule actually operated.

Source-analysis lens

Use colonial reports carefully. They provide valuable administrative detail, but officials often described resistance as disorder. Read them alongside oral traditions, African newspapers, petitions and later historical research.

Political

Who controlled the state, law, army and representation?

Economic

Who controlled land, labour, taxation, trade and resources?

Social

How were communities, education, migration and identity affected?

International

How did war, diplomacy or external powers shape the outcome?

Exam practice

Short response: Why can colonial economies not be described only as European plantations?

Extended writing: "The most important cause of change in this topic was political pressure from colonised peoples." Discuss this statement using specific evidence from the lesson.

Source task: Identify one source that could support the argument and one source that could challenge it. Explain why.

Memory line: Colonial Economies: Land, Labour and Taxation — connect *cause* → *method of control/resistance* → *turning point* → *consequence*.

33 African Resistance and Adaptation

Lesson 13: explanation, chronology and key concepts

LESSON 13

19th to early 20th centuries

Historical overview

African societies responded to imperial expansion in diverse ways. Some states fought long wars; others signed treaties, made temporary alliances or attempted to use one European power against another. Resistance also continued after conquest through tax protests, strikes, religious movements and everyday non-cooperation. Military outcomes depended on leadership, geography, access to weapons, internal politics and the resources imperial states could mobilise.

Key ideas

- Resistance was widespread but took different forms.
- Diplomacy and accommodation could be strategic rather than passive.
- Ethiopia's victory at Adwa became a powerful symbol of African sovereignty.
- Colonial resistance later influenced nationalist memory.

Key terms

resistance

rebellion

Adwa

Maji Maji

Samori Touré

accommodation

Why this lesson matters

The Maji Maji rebellion in German East Africa united diverse communities against colonial demands, especially forced cotton cultivation. German repression and wartime disruption contributed to devastating famine and loss of life.

Date / period	Development
1880s-1890s	Samori Touré resists French expansion
1896	Battle of Adwa
1896-1897	First Chimurenga in southern Africa
1905-1907	Maji Maji rebellion
1904-1908	War and genocide in German South West Africa

Checkpoint

1. Why should accommodation not automatically be seen as collaboration?
2. What factors affected the success of resistance?

34 African Resistance and Adaptation

Lesson 13: case study, comparison and exam practice

LESSON 13 • ANALYSIS

19th to early 20th centuries

Case study focus

The Maji Maji rebellion in German East Africa united diverse communities against colonial demands, especially forced cotton cultivation. German repression and wartime disruption contributed to devastating famine and loss of life.

Main consequences

- Military defeat and political restructuring
- Creation of anti-colonial heroes and memories
- Changes in colonial policies after rebellions
- Continuing local forms of resistance

Comparative thinking

Compare the official ideology of colonial rule with everyday practice. Administrations spoke of order, development or civilisation, but budgets, labour demands, land policies and policing reveal how rule actually operated.

Source-analysis lens

Use colonial reports carefully. They provide valuable administrative detail, but officials often described resistance as disorder. Read them alongside oral traditions, African newspapers, petitions and later historical research.

Political

Who controlled the state, law, army and representation?

Economic

Who controlled land, labour, taxation, trade and resources?

Social

How were communities, education, migration and identity affected?

International

How did war, diplomacy or external powers shape the outcome?

Exam practice

Short response: How did resistance influence later nationalism?

Extended writing: "The most important cause of change in this topic was political pressure from colonised peoples." Discuss this statement using specific evidence from the lesson.

Source task: Identify one source that could support the argument and one source that could challenge it. Explain why.

Memory line: African Resistance and Adaptation — connect *cause* → *method of control/resistance* → *turning point* → *consequence*.

35 Colonisation of North Africa

Lesson 14: explanation, chronology and key concepts

LESSON 14

1830s to mid-20th century

Historical overview

North Africa experienced several forms of European rule. France invaded Algeria in 1830 and gradually developed a large settler population there. Tunisia became a French protectorate in 1881 and Morocco in 1912. Britain occupied Egypt in 1882 while formally preserving links to the Ottoman order for a time. Italy conquered Libya beginning in 1911. Strategic routes, Mediterranean rivalry, land, finance and settler interests shaped colonial control.

Key ideas

- Algeria was treated more like an extension of France than many other colonies.
- European settlement intensified land inequality in several areas.
- Egypt's location and the Suez Canal gave it exceptional strategic importance.
- Nationalist movements combined constitutional, religious, labour and armed strategies.

Key terms

- settler colonialism
- protectorate
- Suez
- pied-noir
- nationalism
- land alienation

Why this lesson matters

In Algeria, European settlers gained strong political influence and access to land, while the Muslim majority faced unequal citizenship structures. This settler-colonial context helps explain why decolonisation became especially violent.

Date / period	Development
1830	French invasion of Algeria
1881	French protectorate in Tunisia
1882	British occupation of Egypt
1911	Italian invasion of Libya
1912	French protectorate in Morocco

Checkpoint

1. Why was Algeria different from many other French colonies?
2. Why was Egypt strategically important?

36 Colonisation of North Africa

Lesson 14: case study, comparison and exam practice

LESSON 14 • ANALYSIS

1830s to mid-20th century

Case study focus

In Algeria, European settlers gained strong political influence and access to land, while the Muslim majority faced unequal citizenship structures. This settler-colonial context helps explain why decolonisation became especially violent.

Main consequences

- Settler communities
- Land redistribution
- Nationalist mobilisation
- Wars of independence and mass migration

Comparative thinking

Compare the official ideology of colonial rule with everyday practice. Administrations spoke of order, development or civilisation, but budgets, labour demands, land policies and policing reveal how rule actually operated.

Source-analysis lens

Use colonial reports carefully. They provide valuable administrative detail, but officials often described resistance as disorder. Read them alongside oral traditions, African newspapers, petitions and later historical research.

Political

Who controlled the state, law, army and representation?

Economic

Who controlled land, labour, taxation, trade and resources?

Social

How were communities, education, migration and identity affected?

International

How did war, diplomacy or external powers shape the outcome?

Exam practice

Short response: How did settler interests affect decolonisation?

Extended writing: “The most important cause of change in this topic was political pressure from colonised peoples.” Discuss this statement using specific evidence from the lesson.

Source task: Identify one source that could support the argument and one source that could challenge it. Explain why.

Memory line: Colonisation of North Africa — connect *cause* → *method of control/resistance* → *turning point* → *consequence*.

37 British India and the Raj

Lesson 15: explanation, chronology and key concepts

LESSON 15

18th century to 1947

Historical overview

British power in India developed first through the East India Company and later through direct Crown rule. Company influence expanded through warfare, treaties, taxation and alliances. The rebellion of 1857 led Britain to abolish Company government and establish the British Raj in 1858. Railways, legal institutions, universities and a large bureaucracy transformed the subcontinent, while colonial economic policies and racial hierarchies generated criticism. Indian nationalism grew through political associations, mass movements, labour action and revolutionary organisations.

Key ideas

- Company rule preceded direct British imperial government.
- The 1857 uprising was a major turning point.
- The Indian National Congress became a major nationalist organisation.
- Nationalism included many ideological, religious and regional currents.

Key terms

Raj East India Company Congress
civil disobedience partition satyagraha

Why this lesson matters

Mahatma Gandhi developed campaigns based on non-cooperation and civil disobedience, but Indian independence was not produced by one leader or one method. Constitutional negotiation, wartime pressures, mass politics and many organisations all mattered.

Date / period	Development
1757	Battle of Plassey
1857	Major uprising against Company rule
1858	British Raj begins
1885	Indian National Congress founded
1947	British India partitioned and independent

Checkpoint

1. How did Company rule differ from the Raj?
2. Why was 1857 a turning point?

38 British India and the Raj

Lesson 15: case study, comparison and exam practice

LESSON 15 • ANALYSIS

18th century to 1947

Case study focus

Mahatma Gandhi developed campaigns based on non-cooperation and civil disobedience, but Indian independence was not produced by one leader or one method. Constitutional negotiation, wartime pressures, mass politics and many organisations all mattered.

Main consequences

- Large colonial bureaucracy
- Expansion of rail and communications
- Growth of modern nationalist politics
- Partition and mass displacement in 1947

Comparative thinking

Compare territorial annexation, protectorates and informal empire. The degree of legal sovereignty differed, but foreign power could still shape trade, diplomacy, taxation and security.

Source-analysis lens

Maps are political documents as well as geographical ones. Check who drew the boundary, when it was created, what communities crossed it, and whether the line reflected local political realities.

Political

Who controlled the state, law, army and representation?

Economic

Who controlled land, labour, taxation, trade and resources?

Social

How were communities, education, migration and identity affected?

International

How did war, diplomacy or external powers shape the outcome?

Exam practice

Short response: Why should Indian independence not be explained by one leader alone?

Extended writing: "The most important cause of change in this topic was political pressure from colonised peoples." Discuss this statement using specific evidence from the lesson.

Source task: Identify one source that could support the argument and one source that could challenge it. Explain why.

Memory line: British India and the Raj — connect *cause* → *method of control/resistance* → *turning point* → *consequence*.

39 French Indochina

Lesson 16: explanation, chronology and key concepts

LESSON 16

19th century to 1954

Historical overview

French Indochina included Vietnam, Cambodia and Laos. French conquest developed during the nineteenth century and created a federation in 1887. Colonial authorities promoted rice, rubber, mining and infrastructure while maintaining political control and unequal legal structures. Education produced a small literate elite, some of whom became critics of colonialism. Vietnamese nationalism included monarchists, republicans, communists and other movements. Japanese occupation during World War II weakened French authority and transformed the political situation.

Key ideas

- French Indochina was a federation, not a single society.
- Plantation and export economies created labour conflicts.
- Nationalism drew on both local traditions and international ideologies.
- World War II created a crisis of colonial authority.

Key terms

Indochina

rubber plantation

Viet Minh

Dien Bien Phu

nationalism

federation

Why this lesson matters

Rubber plantations became symbols of colonial exploitation because workers faced harsh discipline, low wages and dangerous conditions. Labour unrest connected economic grievances with anti-colonial politics.

Date / period	Development
1858	French military intervention begins
1887	Indochinese Union formed
1930	Indochinese Communist Party founded
1940-1945	Japanese presence and occupation
1954	French defeat at Dien Bien Phu

Checkpoint

1. What territories formed French Indochina?
2. How did World War II weaken French control?

40 French Indochina

Lesson 16: case study, comparison and exam practice

LESSON 16 • ANALYSIS

19th century to 1954

Case study focus

Rubber plantations became symbols of colonial exploitation because workers faced harsh discipline, low wages and dangerous conditions. Labour unrest connected economic grievances with anti-colonial politics.

Main consequences

- Export agriculture
- Political radicalisation
- Anti-colonial wars
- Division and prolonged conflict in Vietnam

Comparative thinking

Compare territorial annexation, protectorates and informal empire. The degree of legal sovereignty differed, but foreign power could still shape trade, diplomacy, taxation and security.

Source-analysis lens

Maps are political documents as well as geographical ones. Check who drew the boundary, when it was created, what communities crossed it, and whether the line reflected local political realities.

Political

Who controlled the state, law, army and representation?

Economic

Who controlled land, labour, taxation, trade and resources?

Social

How were communities, education, migration and identity affected?

International

How did war, diplomacy or external powers shape the outcome?

Exam practice

Short response: Why did labour issues become nationalist issues?

Extended writing: "The most important cause of change in this topic was political pressure from colonised peoples." Discuss this statement using specific evidence from the lesson.

Source task: Identify one source that could support the argument and one source that could challenge it. Explain why.

Memory line: French Indochina — connect *cause* → *method of control/resistance* → *turning point* → *consequence*.

41 The Dutch East Indies and the Philippines

Lesson 17: explanation, chronology and key concepts

LESSON 17

19th to mid-20th centuries

Historical overview

The Dutch consolidated control over the Indonesian archipelago through the Dutch East Indies, using plantation systems, taxation and military conquest. In the Philippines, Spanish rule lasted until 1898, when the United States took control after the Spanish-American War and conflict with Filipino nationalists. Both territories developed educated nationalist elites, mass organisations and anti-colonial movements. Japanese occupation during World War II severely disrupted European and American authority and accelerated demands for independence.

Key ideas

- Indonesia and the Philippines experienced different imperial rulers.
- Colonial education helped create nationalist networks.
- The Philippine-American War followed the end of Spanish rule.
- Japanese occupation transformed political and military conditions across Southeast Asia.

Key terms

Dutch East Indies

Cultivation System

Philippine Revolution

Sukarno

republic

occupation

Why this lesson matters

In Indonesia, Sukarno and Mohammad Hatta proclaimed independence on 17 August 1945. The Netherlands attempted to restore colonial authority, but Indonesian resistance and international pressure led to Dutch recognition of sovereignty in 1949.

Date / period	Development
1830	Cultivation System begins in parts of Java
1896	Philippine Revolution begins
1898	Spanish rule ends; US control follows
1942-1945	Japanese occupation
1945-1949	Indonesian revolution against Dutch return

Checkpoint

1. How did colonial rule differ in Indonesia and the Philippines?
2. Why did 1945 matter in Southeast Asia?

42 The Dutch East Indies and the Philippines

Lesson 17: case study, comparison and exam practice

LESSON 17 • ANALYSIS

19th to mid-20th centuries

Case study focus

In Indonesia, Sukarno and Mohammad Hatta proclaimed independence on 17 August 1945. The Netherlands attempted to restore colonial authority, but Indonesian resistance and international pressure led to Dutch recognition of sovereignty in 1949.

Main consequences

- Nationalist mass politics
- Armed independence struggles
- New postcolonial republics
- Debates over language, unity and regional identity

Comparative thinking

Compare territorial annexation, protectorates and informal empire. The degree of legal sovereignty differed, but foreign power could still shape trade, diplomacy, taxation and security.

Source-analysis lens

Maps are political documents as well as geographical ones. Check who drew the boundary, when it was created, what communities crossed it, and whether the line reflected local political realities.

Political

Who controlled the state, law, army and representation?

Economic

Who controlled land, labour, taxation, trade and resources?

Social

How were communities, education, migration and identity affected?

International

How did war, diplomacy or external powers shape the outcome?

Exam practice

Short response: What role did international pressure play in Indonesian independence?

Extended writing: "The most important cause of change in this topic was political pressure from colonised peoples." Discuss this statement using specific evidence from the lesson.

Source task: Identify one source that could support the argument and one source that could challenge it. Explain why.

Memory line: The Dutch East Indies and the Philippines — connect *cause* → *method of control/resistance* → *turning point* → *consequence*.

43 China and the Age of Imperialism

Lesson 18: explanation, chronology and key concepts

LESSON 18

19th to early 20th centuries

Historical overview

China was not colonised as a single territory by one European power, but imperial states imposed unequal treaties, treaty ports, extraterritorial rights and spheres of influence. The Opium Wars weakened Qing sovereignty and opened ports to foreign commerce. Britain, France, Russia, Germany, Japan and others acquired privileges and territories. Chinese responses included reform, rebellion, nationalism and revolution. This form of semi-colonial pressure shows that imperialism could operate without complete territorial annexation.

Key ideas

- Informal empire could limit sovereignty without full colonisation.
- Treaty ports gave foreign powers economic and legal privileges.
- The Boxer Uprising targeted foreign influence and Christian missions.
- Anti-imperialism became central to modern Chinese nationalism.

Key terms

- unequal treaty
- treaty port
- extraterritoriality
- sphere of influence
- Boxer Uprising
- semi-colonialism

Why this lesson matters

Extraterritoriality meant that some foreigners in treaty ports were subject to their own consular courts rather than Chinese law. This was seen by Chinese nationalists as a direct limitation of sovereignty.

Date / period	Development
1839-1842	First Opium War
1856-1860	Second Opium War
1894-1895	Sino-Japanese War
1899-1901	Boxer Uprising and foreign intervention
1911	Qing dynasty falls

Checkpoint

1. Why is China an example of informal imperialism?
2. What was extraterritoriality?

44 China and the Age of Imperialism

Lesson 18: case study, comparison and exam practice

LESSON 18 • ANALYSIS

19th to early 20th centuries

Case study focus

Extraterritoriality meant that some foreigners in treaty ports were subject to their own consular courts rather than Chinese law. This was seen by Chinese nationalists as a direct limitation of sovereignty.

Main consequences

- Loss of tariff and legal autonomy
- Foreign-controlled concessions
- Growth of nationalism
- Reform and revolutionary movements

Comparative thinking

Compare territorial annexation, protectorates and informal empire. The degree of legal sovereignty differed, but foreign power could still shape trade, diplomacy, taxation and security.

Source-analysis lens

Maps are political documents as well as geographical ones. Check who drew the boundary, when it was created, what communities crossed it, and whether the line reflected local political realities.

Political

Who controlled the state, law, army and representation?

Economic

Who controlled land, labour, taxation, trade and resources?

Social

How were communities, education, migration and identity affected?

International

How did war, diplomacy or external powers shape the outcome?

Exam practice

Short response: How did foreign pressure contribute to nationalism?

Extended writing: "The most important cause of change in this topic was political pressure from colonised peoples." Discuss this statement using specific evidence from the lesson.

Source task: Identify one source that could support the argument and one source that could challenge it. Explain why.

Memory line: China and the Age of Imperialism — connect *cause* → *method of control/resistance* → *turning point* → *consequence*.

45 The Middle East and the Mandate System

Lesson 19: explanation, chronology and key concepts

LESSON 19

1918 to mid-20th century

Historical overview

After the First World War, former Ottoman Arab provinces were reorganised under League of Nations mandates. Britain controlled mandates in Iraq and Palestine, while France controlled Syria and Lebanon. The mandate system was presented as temporary tutelage toward self-government, yet it also extended European strategic influence. Borders, competing wartime promises, local nationalist movements and new state institutions created lasting political tensions.

Key ideas

- Mandates were formally different from colonies but still involved outside control.
- Iraq, Syria, Lebanon, Palestine and Transjordan followed different political paths.
- Oil and strategic routes increased external interest in the region.
- Nationalist opposition challenged mandate legitimacy.

Key terms

mandate League of Nations
self-determination Sykes-Picot
Balfour Declaration nationalism

Why this lesson matters

The mandate system used the language of self-determination while reserving extensive powers for Britain and France. This contradiction became a major source of nationalist criticism.

Date / period	Development
1916	Sykes-Picot agreement negotiated
1917	Balfour Declaration
1920	Mandates allocated
1932	Iraq admitted to League of Nations as independent
1940s	French and British mandate rule ends in several territories

Checkpoint

1. How did a mandate differ from a traditional colony?
2. Why did nationalists criticise the mandate system?

46 The Middle East and the Mandate System

Lesson 19: case study, comparison and exam practice

LESSON 19 • ANALYSIS

1918 to mid-20th century

Case study focus

The mandate system used the language of self-determination while reserving extensive powers for Britain and France. This contradiction became a major source of nationalist criticism.

Main consequences

- Creation of new state borders
- Growth of Arab nationalism
- Strategic competition over oil and routes
- Long-term disputes over Palestine

Comparative thinking

Compare territorial annexation, protectorates and informal empire. The degree of legal sovereignty differed, but foreign power could still shape trade, diplomacy, taxation and security.

Source-analysis lens

Maps are political documents as well as geographical ones. Check who drew the boundary, when it was created, what communities crossed it, and whether the line reflected local political realities.

Political

Who controlled the state, law, army and representation?

Economic

Who controlled land, labour, taxation, trade and resources?

Social

How were communities, education, migration and identity affected?

International

How did war, diplomacy or external powers shape the outcome?

Exam practice

Short response: What strategic interests shaped European policy?

Extended writing: "The most important cause of change in this topic was political pressure from colonised peoples." Discuss this statement using specific evidence from the lesson.

Source task: Identify one source that could support the argument and one source that could challenge it. Explain why.

Memory line: The Middle East and the Mandate System — connect *cause* → *method of control/resistance* → *turning point* → *consequence*.

47 Settler Colonialism

Lesson 20: explanation, chronology and key concepts

LESSON 20

Comparative study

Historical overview

Settler colonialism occurs when substantial numbers of settlers establish permanent communities and seek control over land, labour and political institutions. Algeria, Kenya, Rhodesia, South Africa, parts of southern Africa and several earlier colonies in the Americas and Pacific illustrate different forms of this process. Settler populations often demanded political privileges from imperial governments while restricting indigenous access to land and citizenship.

Key ideas

- Land is central to settler colonial systems.
- Settlers could conflict with both indigenous populations and metropolitan governments.
- Racial segregation often became institutionalised.
- Decolonisation was frequently more difficult where settler political power was strong.

Key terms

settler colonialism

land alienation

segregation

minority rule

indigenous

majority rule

Why this lesson matters

In Kenya's 'White Highlands', colonial land policies favoured European settlement in productive areas. Land grievances became a major factor behind the Mau Mau uprising and later independence politics.

Date / period	Development
17th-19th c.	Settler societies expand in several regions
1830s onward	European settlement grows in Algeria
1890s onward	Settler agriculture expands in Kenya and Rhodesia
1948	Apartheid formally established in South Africa
1950s-1980s	Prolonged anti-colonial and majority-rule struggles

Checkpoint

1. What distinguishes settler colonialism from other forms of empire?
2. Why was land so politically important?

48 Settler Colonialism

Lesson 20: case study, comparison and exam practice

LESSON 20 • ANALYSIS

Comparative study

Case study focus

In Kenya's 'White Highlands', colonial land policies favoured European settlement in productive areas. Land grievances became a major factor behind the Mau Mau uprising and later independence politics.

Main consequences

- Land dispossession
- Racial legal systems
- Prolonged political conflict
- Large-scale migration during and after decolonisation

Comparative thinking

Compare territorial annexation, protectorates and informal empire. The degree of legal sovereignty differed, but foreign power could still shape trade, diplomacy, taxation and security.

Source-analysis lens

Maps are political documents as well as geographical ones. Check who drew the boundary, when it was created, what communities crossed it, and whether the line reflected local political realities.

Political

Who controlled the state, law, army and representation?

Economic

Who controlled land, labour, taxation, trade and resources?

Social

How were communities, education, migration and identity affected?

International

How did war, diplomacy or external powers shape the outcome?

Exam practice

Short response: How could settlers constrain decolonisation?

Extended writing: "The most important cause of change in this topic was political pressure from colonised peoples." Discuss this statement using specific evidence from the lesson.

Source task: Identify one source that could support the argument and one source that could challenge it. Explain why.

Memory line: Settler Colonialism — connect *cause* → *method of control/resistance* → *turning point* → *consequence*.

49 Education, Culture, Religion and Colonial Identity

Lesson 21: explanation, chronology and key concepts

LESSON 21

Colonial social transformation

Historical overview

Colonialism transformed cultural and educational institutions. Mission schools and government schools spread European languages and curricula while also producing literate elites who later challenged colonial rule. Christian missions expanded in many regions, but conversion was never uniform and often produced new local religious forms. Colonial classification of ethnic groups, languages and customary law could harden identities that had previously been more flexible. At the same time, colonised peoples adapted, resisted and reinterpreted imported institutions.

Key ideas

- Education could both support colonial administration and nurture nationalism.
- European languages became tools of power and later tools of anti-colonial debate.
- Missionaries sometimes defended colonial policies and sometimes criticised abuses.
- Cultural change was interactive rather than a one-way process.

Key terms

mission school

assimilation

cultural nationalism

vernacular

elite

identity

Why this lesson matters

Many nationalist leaders were educated in colonial schools or universities. Their education exposed them to European political concepts such as citizenship and rights, which they then used to criticise colonial inequality.

Date / period	Development
19th c.	Mission schooling expands
Early 20th c.	Small educated elites grow
1920s-1940s	Student and literary nationalism develops
1950s-1960s	Universities become centres of political debate
Post-independence	Language and curriculum reform becomes a major issue

Checkpoint

1. How could colonial education undermine colonial rule?
2. Why did language become politically important?

50 Education, Culture, Religion and Colonial Identity

Lesson 21: case study, comparison and exam practice

LESSON 21 • ANALYSIS

Colonial social transformation

Case study focus

Many nationalist leaders were educated in colonial schools or universities. Their education exposed them to European political concepts such as citizenship and rights, which they then used to criticise colonial inequality.

Main consequences

- New professional classes
- Language hierarchies
- Religious transformation
- Cultural nationalism and revival movements

Comparative thinking

Compare territorial annexation, protectorates and informal empire. The degree of legal sovereignty differed, but foreign power could still shape trade, diplomacy, taxation and security.

Source-analysis lens

Maps are political documents as well as geographical ones. Check who drew the boundary, when it was created, what communities crossed it, and whether the line reflected local political realities.

Political

Who controlled the state, law, army and representation?

Economic

Who controlled land, labour, taxation, trade and resources?

Social

How were communities, education, migration and identity affected?

International

How did war, diplomacy or external powers shape the outcome?

Exam practice

Short response: Give an example of cultural adaptation rather than simple imitation.

Extended writing: “The most important cause of change in this topic was political pressure from colonised peoples.” Discuss this statement using specific evidence from the lesson.

Source task: Identify one source that could support the argument and one source that could challenge it. Explain why.

Memory line: Education, Culture, Religion and Colonial Identity — connect *cause* → *method of control/resistance* → *turning point* → *consequence*.

51 World War I and the Colonial Empires

Lesson 22: explanation, chronology and key concepts

LESSON 22

1914-1918 and aftermath

Historical overview

World War I was a global imperial war. European powers recruited soldiers, labourers, taxes and raw materials from colonies. Campaigns took place in Africa, the Middle East and the Pacific as Allied forces seized German colonies. Wartime service exposed colonial subjects to new places and political ideas while also creating hardship. After the war, the language of self-determination raised expectations, but European empires largely remained intact and former German and Ottoman territories were redistributed as mandates.

Key ideas

- Colonial soldiers and workers were essential to the war effort.
- German colonies were transferred rather than immediately made independent.
- Wartime promises encouraged nationalist expectations.
- Postwar disappointment contributed to political mobilisation.

Key terms

colonial troops

mandate

self-determination

reparations

mobilisation

veteran

Why this lesson matters

African and Asian soldiers who served in Europe encountered societies claiming to fight for freedom while maintaining colonial rule. This contradiction became a powerful theme in later anti-colonial politics.

Date / period	Development
1914	War begins across imperial networks
1914-1918	Colonial campaigns and recruitment
1918	Armistice
1919	Paris Peace Conference
1919-1920	Mandate system established

Checkpoint

1. Why was World War I a global imperial conflict?
2. What happened to German colonies after the war?

52 World War I and the Colonial Empires

Lesson 22: case study, comparison and exam practice

LESSON 22 • ANALYSIS

1914-1918 and aftermath

Case study focus

African and Asian soldiers who served in Europe encountered societies claiming to fight for freedom while maintaining colonial rule. This contradiction became a powerful theme in later anti-colonial politics.

Main consequences

- Military mobilisation
- Economic strain
- Redistribution of colonies
- Growth of nationalist expectations

Comparative thinking

Compare elite nationalism with mass mobilisation. Political leaders mattered, but workers, peasants, soldiers, women, students, veterans and religious networks often turned constitutional demands into mass movements.

Source-analysis lens

When analysing speeches about self-determination, compare words with policy. Governments could support freedom in principle while resisting independence where strategic or economic interests were at stake.

Political

Who controlled the state, law, army and representation?

Economic

Who controlled land, labour, taxation, trade and resources?

Social

How were communities, education, migration and identity affected?

International

How did war, diplomacy or external powers shape the outcome?

Exam practice

Short response: How did wartime rhetoric affect nationalist politics?

Extended writing: "The most important cause of change in this topic was political pressure from colonised peoples." Discuss this statement using specific evidence from the lesson.

Source task: Identify one source that could support the argument and one source that could challenge it. Explain why.

Memory line: World War I and the Colonial Empires — connect *cause* → *method of control/resistance* → *turning point* → *consequence*.

53 Interwar Nationalism and Political Organisation

Lesson 23: explanation, chronology and key concepts

LESSON 23

1919-1939

Historical overview

Between the world wars, anti-colonial nationalism became more organised. Political parties, trade unions, newspapers, student groups, religious associations and diaspora networks linked local grievances to international ideas. Pan-Africanism, communism, liberal constitutionalism, Islamic reform and cultural nationalism offered different visions. Colonial governments alternated between limited reform and repression. The Great Depression intensified social tensions as falling commodity prices hurt producers and workers.

Key ideas

- Nationalism was ideologically diverse.
- Urban workers and students became increasingly important political actors.
- Diaspora activists connected colonial struggles across borders.
- Economic crisis could transform social grievances into political demands.

Key terms

Pan-Africanism

trade union

diaspora

constitutional reform

mass party

anti-imperialism

Why this lesson matters

Italy's invasion of Ethiopia in 1935 provoked outrage among Africans and the African diaspora because Ethiopia symbolised independent African statehood. The League of Nations' weak response damaged faith in collective security.

Date / period	Development
1919	Postwar protests in several colonies
1920s	Pan-African and nationalist networks grow
1929	Great Depression begins
1930	Salt March in India
1935-1936	Italian conquest of Ethiopia inspires global anti-imperial protest

Checkpoint

1. Why was interwar nationalism not a single ideology?
2. How did the Great Depression affect colonial politics?

54 Interwar Nationalism and Political Organisation

Lesson 23: case study, comparison and exam practice

LESSON 23 • ANALYSIS

1919-1939

Case study focus

Italy's invasion of Ethiopia in 1935 provoked outrage among Africans and the African diaspora because Ethiopia symbolised independent African statehood. The League of Nations' weak response damaged faith in collective security.

Main consequences

- Growth of mass parties
- Trade union activism
- Stronger international anti-imperial networks
- Radicalisation under economic pressure

Comparative thinking

Compare elite nationalism with mass mobilisation. Political leaders mattered, but workers, peasants, soldiers, women, students, veterans and religious networks often turned constitutional demands into mass movements.

Source-analysis lens

When analysing speeches about self-determination, compare words with policy. Governments could support freedom in principle while resisting independence where strategic or economic interests were at stake.

Political

Who controlled the state, law, army and representation?

Economic

Who controlled land, labour, taxation, trade and resources?

Social

How were communities, education, migration and identity affected?

International

How did war, diplomacy or external powers shape the outcome?

Exam practice

Short response: Why did Ethiopia matter symbolically?

Extended writing: "The most important cause of change in this topic was political pressure from colonised peoples." Discuss this statement using specific evidence from the lesson.

Source task: Identify one source that could support the argument and one source that could challenge it. Explain why.

Memory line: Interwar Nationalism and Political Organisation — connect *cause* → *method of control/resistance* → *turning point* → *consequence*.

55 World War II: The Decolonisation Turning Point

Lesson 24: explanation, chronology and key concepts

LESSON 24

1939-1945

Historical overview

World War II weakened European imperial powers economically and militarily. Japan defeated or displaced European colonial administrations across Southeast Asia, undermining assumptions of European invincibility. Millions of colonial soldiers and workers contributed to Allied victory. Anti-fascist rhetoric, the Atlantic Charter, growing United States and Soviet opposition to old-style empire, and the creation of the United Nations strengthened arguments for self-determination. Yet decolonisation after 1945 was neither immediate nor peaceful everywhere.

Key ideas

- European prestige suffered from military defeat and occupation.
- Colonial contributions to the war increased demands for rights.
- The UN provided a new international language for self-determination.
- Former imperial states still tried to restore control in several territories.

Key terms

- Atlantic Charter
- United Nations
- self-determination
- occupation
- anti-fascism
- postwar order

Why this lesson matters

Japan's defeat of British forces in Singapore in 1942 had major symbolic importance. It demonstrated that a European empire could be defeated by an Asian power, even though Japanese occupation itself was often harsh and coercive.

Date / period	Development
1939	World War II begins in Europe
1941	Atlantic Charter issued
1942	Japanese conquests in Southeast Asia
1945	War ends; UN founded
Late 1940s	Major independence conflicts in Asia

Checkpoint

1. Why did World War II weaken European empires?
2. How did Japanese expansion affect colonial legitimacy?

56 World War II: The Decolonisation Turning Point

Lesson 24: case study, comparison and exam practice

LESSON 24 • ANALYSIS

1939-1945

Case study focus

Japan's defeat of British forces in Singapore in 1942 had major symbolic importance. It demonstrated that a European empire could be defeated by an Asian power, even though Japanese occupation itself was often harsh and coercive.

Main consequences

- Economic weakness of imperial powers
- Armed nationalist movements
- International support for self-government
- Rapid postwar constitutional change

Comparative thinking

Compare elite nationalism with mass mobilisation. Political leaders mattered, but workers, peasants, soldiers, women, students, veterans and religious networks often turned constitutional demands into mass movements.

Source-analysis lens

When analysing speeches about self-determination, compare words with policy. Governments could support freedom in principle while resisting independence where strategic or economic interests were at stake.

Political

Who controlled the state, law, army and representation?

Economic

Who controlled land, labour, taxation, trade and resources?

Social

How were communities, education, migration and identity affected?

International

How did war, diplomacy or external powers shape the outcome?

Exam practice

Short response: Why did decolonisation still remain difficult after 1945?

Extended writing: "The most important cause of change in this topic was political pressure from colonised peoples." Discuss this statement using specific evidence from the lesson.

Source task: Identify one source that could support the argument and one source that could challenge it. Explain why.

Memory line: World War II: The Decolonisation Turning Point — connect *cause* → *method of control/resistance* → *turning point* → *consequence*.

57 India, Pakistan and Partition

Lesson 25: explanation, chronology and key concepts

LESSON 25

1945-1947

Historical overview

After World War II, Britain moved toward ending rule in India amid mass nationalist pressure, communal tensions, economic exhaustion and political negotiations. The Indian National Congress and the Muslim League disagreed over the constitutional future. British India was partitioned into India and Pakistan in August 1947. Independence was accompanied by enormous population movements and communal violence, especially across Punjab and Bengal. The princely states also had to determine their political future.

Key ideas

- Independence and partition occurred together but were not the same process.
- Congress and the Muslim League represented different constitutional visions.
- Partition displaced millions of people.
- The Kashmir dispute emerged from the unsettled process of state accession.

Key terms

- partition
- Muslim League
- Congress
- communal violence
- princely state
- Kashmir

Why this lesson matters

Partition illustrates that decolonisation can solve one question of sovereignty while generating new disputes over borders, minorities and citizenship. It remains one of the largest forced migrations of the twentieth century.

Date / period	Development
1942	Quit India movement
1946	Cabinet Mission and communal violence
3 June 1947	Partition plan announced
14-15 Aug 1947	Pakistan and India become independent
1947-1948	First India-Pakistan war over Kashmir

Checkpoint

1. Why did partition occur?
2. What human consequences followed the new borders?

58 India, Pakistan and Partition

Lesson 25: case study, comparison and exam practice

LESSON 25 • ANALYSIS

1945-1947

Case study focus

Partition illustrates that decolonisation can solve one question of sovereignty while generating new disputes over borders, minorities and citizenship. It remains one of the largest forced migrations of the twentieth century.

Main consequences

- End of British Raj
- Creation of India and Pakistan
- Mass migration and violence
- Long-term interstate rivalry

Comparative thinking

Compare elite nationalism with mass mobilisation. Political leaders mattered, but workers, peasants, soldiers, women, students, veterans and religious networks often turned constitutional demands into mass movements.

Source-analysis lens

When analysing speeches about self-determination, compare words with policy. Governments could support freedom in principle while resisting independence where strategic or economic interests were at stake.

Political

Who controlled the state, law, army and representation?

Economic

Who controlled land, labour, taxation, trade and resources?

Social

How were communities, education, migration and identity affected?

International

How did war, diplomacy or external powers shape the outcome?

Exam practice

Short response: How does partition complicate a simple story of successful independence?

Extended writing: "The most important cause of change in this topic was political pressure from colonised peoples." Discuss this statement using specific evidence from the lesson.

Source task: Identify one source that could support the argument and one source that could challenge it. Explain why.

Memory line: India, Pakistan and Partition — connect *cause* → *method of control/resistance* → *turning point* → *consequence*.

59 Indonesia: Revolution and Sovereignty

Lesson 26: explanation, chronology and key concepts

LESSON 26

1945-1949

Historical overview

Indonesian nationalists proclaimed independence immediately after Japan's surrender in August 1945. The Netherlands attempted to re-establish colonial rule, leading to four years of warfare, negotiation and international diplomacy. Indonesian republican forces controlled some areas while Dutch forces held others. The conflict became increasingly costly and attracted criticism from the United Nations, the United States and newly independent Asian states. In December 1949, the Netherlands transferred sovereignty to the United States of Indonesia, except for western New Guinea, which remained disputed.

Key ideas

- Japanese occupation destroyed the prewar colonial order.
- Indonesian independence combined armed struggle and diplomacy.
- International opinion increasingly constrained Dutch policy.
- Postcolonial state-building required uniting a very diverse archipelago.

Key terms

Sukarno Hatta Republic of Indonesia
police action sovereignty transfer
revolution

Why this lesson matters

The Indonesian Revolution shows that international pressure mattered most when combined with determined local resistance and the political costs of prolonged colonial warfare.

Date / period	Development
17 Aug 1945	Independence proclaimed
1946	Linggadjati Agreement
1947	First Dutch 'police action'
1948	Second Dutch military offensive
Dec 1949	Dutch sovereignty transfer

Checkpoint

1. Why did independence not become secure in August 1945?
2. How did the UN and other states influence the conflict?

60 Indonesia: Revolution and Sovereignty

Lesson 26: case study, comparison and exam practice

LESSON 26 • ANALYSIS

1945-1949

Case study focus

The Indonesian Revolution shows that international pressure mattered most when combined with determined local resistance and the political costs of prolonged colonial warfare.

Main consequences

- End of Dutch rule
- Rise of Indonesian nationalism
- Military influence in politics
- Continuing regional integration challenges

Comparative thinking

Compare negotiated transition with armed struggle. Most decolonisation contained both pressure and negotiation; the balance depended on settler interests, military capacity, international pressure, nationalist unity and metropolitan politics.

Source-analysis lens

Independence-day speeches are powerful sources for political goals, but they are not neutral descriptions of the past. Identify what kind of nation the speaker wanted to create and which conflicts or groups were left outside the narrative.

Political

Who controlled the state, law, army and representation?

Economic

Who controlled land, labour, taxation, trade and resources?

Social

How were communities, education, migration and identity affected?

International

How did war, diplomacy or external powers shape the outcome?

Exam practice

Short response: What challenges faced the new Indonesian state?

Extended writing: "The most important cause of change in this topic was political pressure from colonised peoples." Discuss this statement using specific evidence from the lesson.

Source task: Identify one source that could support the argument and one source that could challenge it. Explain why.

Memory line: Indonesia: Revolution and Sovereignty — connect *cause* → *method of control/resistance* → *turning point* → *consequence*.

61 Vietnam and the End of French Indochina

Lesson 27: explanation, chronology and key concepts

LESSON 27

1945-1954

Historical overview

Ho Chi Minh proclaimed the Democratic Republic of Vietnam in September 1945, but France sought to restore colonial rule. Negotiations failed, and the First Indochina War began in 1946 between French forces and the Viet Minh. The conflict became connected to the emerging Cold War: communist China supported the Viet Minh after 1949, while the United States increasingly financed the French effort. The decisive French defeat at Dien Bien Phu in 1954 led to the Geneva agreements and the temporary division of Vietnam.

Key ideas

- Vietnamese decolonisation became entangled with Cold War rivalry.
- The Viet Minh combined nationalism and communism.
- French military power did not guarantee political control.
- The 1954 settlement did not end conflict in Vietnam.

Key terms

Viet Minh

Ho Chi Minh

Dien Bien Phu

Geneva Accords

Cold War

guerrilla warfare

Why this lesson matters

Dien Bien Phu became a global symbol because a colonised people defeated a major European army in a set-piece battle, inspiring anti-colonial movements far beyond Vietnam.

Date / period	Development
2 Sep 1945	Vietnamese independence proclaimed
1946	First Indochina War begins
1949-1950	Cold War support intensifies
May 1954	French defeated at Dien Bien Phu
July 1954	Geneva agreements

Checkpoint

1. Why did the First Indochina War become internationalised?
2. Why was Dien Bien Phu symbolically important?

62 Vietnam and the End of French Indochina

Lesson 27: case study, comparison and exam practice

LESSON 27 • ANALYSIS

1945-1954

Case study focus

Dien Bien Phu became a global symbol because a colonised people defeated a major European army in a set-piece battle, inspiring anti-colonial movements far beyond Vietnam.

Main consequences

- End of French Indochina
- Temporary division of Vietnam
- Cold War escalation
- Inspiration for other liberation movements

Comparative thinking

Compare negotiated transition with armed struggle. Most decolonisation contained both pressure and negotiation; the balance depended on settler interests, military capacity, international pressure, nationalist unity and metropolitan politics.

Source-analysis lens

Independence-day speeches are powerful sources for political goals, but they are not neutral descriptions of the past. Identify what kind of nation the speaker wanted to create and which conflicts or groups were left outside the narrative.

Political

Who controlled the state, law, army and representation?

Economic

Who controlled land, labour, taxation, trade and resources?

Social

How were communities, education, migration and identity affected?

International

How did war, diplomacy or external powers shape the outcome?

Exam practice

Short response: Why did 1954 not bring lasting peace?

Extended writing: "The most important cause of change in this topic was political pressure from colonised peoples." Discuss this statement using specific evidence from the lesson.

Source task: Identify one source that could support the argument and one source that could challenge it. Explain why.

Memory line: Vietnam and the End of French Indochina — connect *cause* → *method of control/resistance* → *turning point* → *consequence*.

63 Decolonisation in North Africa

Lesson 28: explanation, chronology and key concepts

LESSON 28

1950s-1960s

Historical overview

Morocco and Tunisia gained independence from France in 1956 after political mobilisation, negotiation and periods of unrest. Algeria followed a very different path. The National Liberation Front (FLN) launched an armed struggle in 1954 against French rule. Because Algeria contained a large European settler population and was legally integrated into France, the war became a major crisis for both Algeria and metropolitan France. The 1962 Evian Accords opened the way to Algerian independence and large-scale migration.

Key ideas

- North African decolonisation followed different routes.
- Settler power made Algeria especially difficult to decolonise.
- The Algerian War involved guerrilla warfare, terrorism, torture and mass displacement.
- The conflict contributed to the collapse of France's Fourth Republic.

Key terms

FLN

Evian Accords

pied-noir

harki

counterinsurgency

Algerian War

Why this lesson matters

The Battle of Algiers became famous for urban guerrilla tactics and French counterinsurgency, including systematic torture. It remains a key case in debates about colonial warfare and state violence.

Date / period	Development
1954	FLN launches Algerian uprising
1956	Morocco and Tunisia independent
1958	French Fifth Republic established
1961	Negotiations accelerate
1962	Algeria becomes independent

Checkpoint

1. Why was Algeria's decolonisation more violent than Morocco's or Tunisia's?
2. How did the war affect France?

64 Decolonisation in North Africa

Lesson 28: case study, comparison and exam practice

LESSON 28 • ANALYSIS

1950s-1960s

Case study focus

The Battle of Algiers became famous for urban guerrilla tactics and French counterinsurgency, including systematic torture. It remains a key case in debates about colonial warfare and state violence.

Main consequences

- Independent North African states
- Migration of European settlers and harkis
- Political transformation in France
- Powerful global image of armed liberation

Comparative thinking

Compare negotiated transition with armed struggle. Most decolonisation contained both pressure and negotiation; the balance depended on settler interests, military capacity, international pressure, nationalist unity and metropolitan politics.

Source-analysis lens

Independence-day speeches are powerful sources for political goals, but they are not neutral descriptions of the past. Identify what kind of nation the speaker wanted to create and which conflicts or groups were left outside the narrative.

Political

Who controlled the state, law, army and representation?

Economic

Who controlled land, labour, taxation, trade and resources?

Social

How were communities, education, migration and identity affected?

International

How did war, diplomacy or external powers shape the outcome?

Exam practice

Short response: What ethical questions arise from counterinsurgency methods?

Extended writing: "The most important cause of change in this topic was political pressure from colonised peoples." Discuss this statement using specific evidence from the lesson.

Source task: Identify one source that could support the argument and one source that could challenge it. Explain why.

Memory line: Decolonisation in North Africa — connect *cause* → *method of control/resistance* → *turning point* → *consequence*.

65 Ghana and West African Decolonisation

Lesson 29: explanation, chronology and key concepts

LESSON 29

1940s-1960s

Historical overview

The Gold Coast became Ghana in 1957, the first sub-Saharan African colony to gain independence in the postwar wave. Kwame Nkrumah and the Convention People's Party mobilised through strikes, elections and demands for 'self-government now'. British constitutional reforms gradually expanded African representation. Ghana's independence inspired movements across the continent. In French West Africa, decolonisation often proceeded through constitutional changes, the 1958 French Community referendum and rapid independence in 1960.

Key ideas

- Mass political organisation was central to Ghanaian independence.
- British decolonisation often used staged constitutional reforms.
- 1960 became known as the 'Year of Africa' because many states became independent.
- Pan-African cooperation became a major goal for leaders such as Nkrumah.

Key terms

- Gold Coast
- Nkrumah
- CPP
- Pan-Africanism
- self-government
- Year of Africa

Why this lesson matters

Nkrumah argued that Ghanaian independence was incomplete without the liberation of the rest of Africa. This linked national sovereignty to Pan-African political cooperation.

Date / period	Development
1948	Accra riots
1949	Convention People's Party formed
1951	Nkrumah's party wins election
6 Mar 1957	Ghana independent
1960	Large wave of African independence

Checkpoint

1. Why is Ghana's independence historically important?
2. How did constitutional reform contribute to decolonisation?

66 Ghana and West African Decolonisation

Lesson 29: case study, comparison and exam practice

LESSON 29 • ANALYSIS

1940s-1960s

Case study focus

Nkrumah argued that Ghanaian independence was incomplete without the liberation of the rest of Africa. This linked national sovereignty to Pan-African political cooperation.

Main consequences

- Model for negotiated decolonisation
- Expansion of mass-party politics
- Pan-African diplomacy
- New challenges of economic development

Comparative thinking

Compare negotiated transition with armed struggle. Most decolonisation contained both pressure and negotiation; the balance depended on settler interests, military capacity, international pressure, nationalist unity and metropolitan politics.

Source-analysis lens

Independence-day speeches are powerful sources for political goals, but they are not neutral descriptions of the past. Identify what kind of nation the speaker wanted to create and which conflicts or groups were left outside the narrative.

Political

Who controlled the state, law, army and representation?

Economic

Who controlled land, labour, taxation, trade and resources?

Social

How were communities, education, migration and identity affected?

International

How did war, diplomacy or external powers shape the outcome?

Exam practice

Short response: What did Nkrumah mean by linking Ghana to African liberation?

Extended writing: "The most important cause of change in this topic was political pressure from colonised peoples." Discuss this statement using specific evidence from the lesson.

Source task: Identify one source that could support the argument and one source that could challenge it. Explain why.

Memory line: Ghana and West African Decolonisation — connect *cause* → *method of control/resistance* → *turning point* → *consequence*.

67 Kenya and East African Decolonisation

Lesson 30: explanation, chronology and key concepts

LESSON 30

1950s-1960s

Historical overview

Kenya's decolonisation was shaped by settler land ownership, African political mobilisation and the Mau Mau rebellion. From 1952, the colonial government declared an Emergency and used detention, forced resettlement and military operations against insurgents, many of whom came from Kikuyu communities. At the same time, constitutional negotiations gradually expanded African political representation. Jomo Kenyatta became the leading figure in the transition to independence in 1963.

Key ideas

- Land grievances were central to Kenyan nationalism.
- The Mau Mau conflict was both an anti-colonial struggle and a complex internal civil conflict.
- Colonial counterinsurgency included widespread detention and abuses.
- Independence emerged through both conflict and negotiation.

Key terms

Mau Mau

Emergency

Kenyatta

settler

detention

Lancaster House

Why this lesson matters

Mau Mau memory remained politically contested after independence because the rebellion divided communities as well as challenging colonial rule. Later historical research and legal cases brought renewed attention to abuses in detention camps.

Date / period	Development
1952	State of Emergency declared
1950s	Mau Mau insurgency and counterinsurgency
1960	Lancaster House constitutional talks
12 Dec 1963	Kenya independent
1964	Kenya becomes a republic

Checkpoint

1. Why was land so important in Kenya?
2. Why is Mau Mau historically complex?

68 Kenya and East African Decolonisation

Lesson 30: case study, comparison and exam practice

LESSON 30 • ANALYSIS

1950s-1960s

Case study focus

Mau Mau memory remained politically contested after independence because the rebellion divided communities as well as challenging colonial rule. Later historical research and legal cases brought renewed attention to abuses in detention camps.

Main consequences

- End of settler political dominance
- Land redistribution debates
- Strong executive state
- Powerful memory of rebellion and detention

Comparative thinking

Compare negotiated transition with armed struggle. Most decolonisation contained both pressure and negotiation; the balance depended on settler interests, military capacity, international pressure, nationalist unity and metropolitan politics.

Source-analysis lens

Independence-day speeches are powerful sources for political goals, but they are not neutral descriptions of the past. Identify what kind of nation the speaker wanted to create and which conflicts or groups were left outside the narrative.

Political

Who controlled the state, law, army and representation?

Economic

Who controlled land, labour, taxation, trade and resources?

Social

How were communities, education, migration and identity affected?

International

How did war, diplomacy or external powers shape the outcome?

Exam practice

Short response: How did armed conflict and negotiation interact?

Extended writing: "The most important cause of change in this topic was political pressure from colonised peoples." Discuss this statement using specific evidence from the lesson.

Source task: Identify one source that could support the argument and one source that could challenge it. Explain why.

Memory line: Kenya and East African Decolonisation — connect *cause* → *method of control/resistance* → *turning point* → *consequence*.

69 The Congo Crisis

Lesson 31: explanation, chronology and key concepts

LESSON 31

1960-1965

Historical overview

The Belgian Congo became independent on 30 June 1960 after a very rapid political transition. Within days, the army mutinied, Belgian troops intervened, and the mineral-rich province of Katanga declared secession. Prime Minister Patrice Lumumba and President Joseph Kasavubu came into conflict, while the United Nations deployed a large peacekeeping mission. The crisis became entangled with Cold War rivalry. Lumumba was removed from power and killed in 1961. Joseph-Désiré Mobutu eventually seized power in 1965.

Key ideas

- Independence came with very limited preparation for national political administration.
- Control of mineral wealth was central to the Katanga crisis.
- Belgium, the UN, the United States and the Soviet Union all became involved.
- The crisis illustrates the overlap of decolonisation and Cold War politics.

Key terms

Lumumba

Katanga

secession

peacekeeping

Mobutu

Cold War

Why this lesson matters

The Congo Crisis cannot be explained only as an internal conflict. Colonial institutional weaknesses, resource interests, secession, foreign intervention and superpower rivalry all interacted.

Date / period	Development
30 Jun 1960	Congo independent
Jul 1960	Army mutiny and Katanga secession
1960	UN mission deployed
Jan 1961	Lumumba killed
1965	Mobutu takes power

Checkpoint

1. Why did the Congo crisis develop so quickly after independence?
2. Why was Katanga important?

70 The Congo Crisis

Lesson 31: case study, comparison and exam practice

LESSON 31 • ANALYSIS

1960-1965

Case study focus

The Congo Crisis cannot be explained only as an internal conflict. Colonial institutional weaknesses, resource interests, secession, foreign intervention and superpower rivalry all interacted.

Main consequences

- Political instability
- Foreign intervention
- Centralisation under Mobutu
- Enduring debates over external responsibility

Comparative thinking

Compare negotiated transition with armed struggle. Most decolonisation contained both pressure and negotiation; the balance depended on settler interests, military capacity, international pressure, nationalist unity and metropolitan politics.

Source-analysis lens

Independence-day speeches are powerful sources for political goals, but they are not neutral descriptions of the past. Identify what kind of nation the speaker wanted to create and which conflicts or groups were left outside the narrative.

Political

Who controlled the state, law, army and representation?

Economic

Who controlled land, labour, taxation, trade and resources?

Social

How were communities, education, migration and identity affected?

International

How did war, diplomacy or external powers shape the outcome?

Exam practice

Short response: How did Cold War rivalry change the conflict?

Extended writing: "The most important cause of change in this topic was political pressure from colonised peoples." Discuss this statement using specific evidence from the lesson.

Source task: Identify one source that could support the argument and one source that could challenge it. Explain why.

Memory line: The Congo Crisis — connect *cause* → *method of control/resistance* → *turning point* → *consequence*.

71 Southern Africa: Liberation and Majority Rule

Lesson 32: explanation, chronology and key concepts

LESSON 32

1960s-1990

Historical overview

Decolonisation in southern Africa lasted longer than in much of the continent. Portugal fought wars against liberation movements in Angola, Mozambique and Guinea-Bissau until the 1974 Carnation Revolution in Portugal ended the political basis for empire. Rhodesia's white minority government declared unilateral independence in 1965 and later became Zimbabwe in 1980 after war and negotiation. Namibia achieved independence from South African rule in 1990. South Africa itself remained under apartheid until the democratic transition of the early 1990s.

Key ideas

- Settler and minority regimes delayed majority rule.
- Cold War powers supported competing movements in Angola and elsewhere.
- Portugal's domestic revolution transformed African decolonisation.
- Regional liberation struggles were interconnected.

Key terms

liberation movement

UDI

FRELIMO

MPLA

SWAPO

majority rule

Why this lesson matters

Angola became independent in 1975 but immediately entered a prolonged civil war involving domestic movements and outside powers including Cuba, South Africa, the Soviet Union and the United States.

Date / period	Development
1961	Angolan war begins
1964	Mozambican war begins
1965	Rhodesian UDI
1975	Angola and Mozambique independent
1980	Zimbabwe independent
1990	Namibia independent

Checkpoint

1. Why did southern African decolonisation last longer?
2. How did the Cold War affect Angola?

72 Southern Africa: Liberation and Majority Rule

Lesson 32: case study, comparison and exam practice

LESSON 32 • ANALYSIS

1960s-1990

Case study focus

Angola became independent in 1975 but immediately entered a prolonged civil war involving domestic movements and outside powers including Cuba, South Africa, the Soviet Union and the United States.

Main consequences

- Late independence
- Civil wars
- Refugee movements
- Regional struggles against apartheid

Comparative thinking

Compare negotiated transition with armed struggle. Most decolonisation contained both pressure and negotiation; the balance depended on settler interests, military capacity, international pressure, nationalist unity and metropolitan politics.

Source-analysis lens

Independence-day speeches are powerful sources for political goals, but they are not neutral descriptions of the past. Identify what kind of nation the speaker wanted to create and which conflicts or groups were left outside the narrative.

Political

Who controlled the state, law, army and representation?

Economic

Who controlled land, labour, taxation, trade and resources?

Social

How were communities, education, migration and identity affected?

International

How did war, diplomacy or external powers shape the outcome?

Exam practice

Short response: Why was Portugal's 1974 revolution important?

Extended writing: "The most important cause of change in this topic was political pressure from colonised peoples." Discuss this statement using specific evidence from the lesson.

Source task: Identify one source that could support the argument and one source that could challenge it. Explain why.

Memory line: Southern Africa: Liberation and Majority Rule — connect *cause* → *method of control/resistance* → *turning point* → *consequence*.

73

Madagascar: Colonisation and Independence

Lesson 33: explanation, chronology and key concepts

LESSON 33

1896-1960

Historical overview

France formally annexed Madagascar in 1896 after military intervention against the Merina monarchy. Colonial rule reorganised administration, taxation, labour and export production and expanded infrastructure and French-language education. Resistance occurred from the beginning and continued in different forms. The Malagasy Uprising of 1947 was met by severe French repression and became a major reference point in nationalist memory. Political reforms in the 1950s led toward the Malagasy Republic and full independence on 26 June 1960.

Key ideas

- French annexation ended the sovereignty of the Merina monarchy.
- Colonial labour and taxation affected rural communities.
- The 1947 uprising became central to the memory of anti-colonial resistance.
- Independence emerged through both resistance and constitutional negotiation.

Key terms

Merina monarchy

annexation

1947 uprising

French Community

independence

national memory

Why this lesson matters

The 1947 uprising involved several regions and forms of resistance. French repression caused extensive suffering. Historical estimates of casualties vary, so careful study distinguishes documented events from uncertain numerical claims.

Date / period	Development
1895	French military expedition
1896	Formal annexation by France
1947	Malagasy Uprising
1958	Malagasy Republic within the French Community
26 Jun 1960	Full independence

Checkpoint

1. How did French rule transform Madagascar?
2. Why is 1947 important in Malagasy national history?

74 Madagascar: Colonisation and Independence

Lesson 33: case study, comparison and exam practice

LESSON 33 • ANALYSIS

1896-1960

Case study focus

The 1947 uprising involved several regions and forms of resistance. French repression caused extensive suffering. Historical estimates of casualties vary, so careful study distinguishes documented events from uncertain numerical claims.

Main consequences

- Administrative centralisation
- Economic and educational transformation
- Nationalist political mobilisation
- Continuing debates about memory, language and colonial legacies

Comparative thinking

Compare negotiated transition with armed struggle. Most decolonisation contained both pressure and negotiation; the balance depended on settler interests, military capacity, international pressure, nationalist unity and metropolitan politics.

Source-analysis lens

Independence-day speeches are powerful sources for political goals, but they are not neutral descriptions of the past. Identify what kind of nation the speaker wanted to create and which conflicts or groups were left outside the narrative.

Political

Who controlled the state, law, army and representation?

Economic

Who controlled land, labour, taxation, trade and resources?

Social

How were communities, education, migration and identity affected?

International

How did war, diplomacy or external powers shape the outcome?

Exam practice

Short response: What political steps led to independence in 1960?

Extended writing: "The most important cause of change in this topic was political pressure from colonised peoples." Discuss this statement using specific evidence from the lesson.

Source task: Identify one source that could support the argument and one source that could challenge it. Explain why.

Memory line: Madagascar: Colonisation and Independence — connect *cause* → *method of control/resistance* → *turning point* → *consequence*.

75 The Cold War, Non-Alignment and Colonial Legacies

Lesson 34: explanation, chronology and key concepts

LESSON 34

1945 to the present

Historical overview

Decolonisation unfolded within a bipolar Cold War world. The United States and Soviet Union publicly criticised old colonialism while also pursuing strategic interests and supporting allies. Newly independent states often tried to avoid simple alignment with either bloc. The 1955 Bandung Conference and the later Non-Aligned Movement promoted Afro-Asian cooperation, sovereignty and anti-colonialism. Independence created new possibilities, but postcolonial governments inherited borders, export structures, administrative systems and social inequalities shaped by colonial rule.

Key ideas

- Cold War rivalry could support or destabilise decolonising states.
- Non-alignment was an active strategy, not simply neutrality.
- Colonial borders often became international borders after independence.
- The term neo-colonialism describes continuing external influence after formal independence.

Key terms

Bandung

Non-Aligned Movement

neo-colonialism

postcolonial

sovereignty

development

Why this lesson matters

At Bandung, leaders from Asia and Africa discussed economic cooperation, anti-colonialism, racial equality and peaceful coexistence. The conference symbolised the growing diplomatic voice of formerly colonised societies.

Date / period	Development
1945	United Nations founded
1955	Bandung Conference
1961	Non-Aligned Movement formally established
1963	Organisation of African Unity founded
1970s-1990s	Late decolonisation and postcolonial restructuring

Checkpoint

1. What was non-alignment?
2. Why did colonial borders usually survive independence?

76 The Cold War, Non-Alignment and Colonial Legacies

Lesson 34: case study, comparison and exam practice

LESSON 34 • ANALYSIS

1945 to the present

Case study focus

At Bandung, leaders from Asia and Africa discussed economic cooperation, anti-colonialism, racial equality and peaceful coexistence. The conference symbolised the growing diplomatic voice of formerly colonised societies.

Main consequences

- New international organisations
- Development and debt debates
- Border and citizenship conflicts
- Cultural and historical reassessment of empire

Comparative thinking

Compare negotiated transition with armed struggle. Most decolonisation contained both pressure and negotiation; the balance depended on settler interests, military capacity, international pressure, nationalist unity and metropolitan politics.

Source-analysis lens

Independence-day speeches are powerful sources for political goals, but they are not neutral descriptions of the past. Identify what kind of nation the speaker wanted to create and which conflicts or groups were left outside the narrative.

Political

Who controlled the state, law, army and representation?

Economic

Who controlled land, labour, taxation, trade and resources?

Social

How were communities, education, migration and identity affected?

International

How did war, diplomacy or external powers shape the outcome?

Exam practice

Short response: How is neo-colonialism different from formal colonial rule?

Extended writing: "The most important cause of change in this topic was political pressure from colonised peoples." Discuss this statement using specific evidence from the lesson.

Source task: Identify one source that could support the argument and one source that could challenge it. Explain why.

Memory line: The Cold War, Non-Alignment and Colonial Legacies — connect *cause* → *method of control/resistance* → *turning point* → *consequence*.

77 Comprehensive Review Test

Knowledge, comparison and chronology

Part A — Knowledge (20 marks)

1. Define colonialism and imperialism.
2. Give one difference between direct and indirect rule.
3. Why was the Berlin Conference important?
4. Name two effects of colonial taxation.
5. Why is the Battle of Adwa significant?
6. What changed in India after the uprising of 1857?
7. What was the mandate system?
8. Why did World War II accelerate decolonisation?
9. Why was 1960 called the Year of Africa?
10. What was the Non-Aligned Movement?

Part B — Structured responses (30 marks)

1. Compare British and French colonial rule in Africa.
2. Compare Indian and Algerian decolonisation.
3. Explain how settler colonialism affected independence struggles.
4. Explain how the Cold War influenced one decolonisation conflict.
5. Assess whether economic factors were more important than political ideas in the growth of imperialism.

Part C — Chronology challenge

Place these in correct order and give a one-sentence significance for each: **Bandung Conference • Battle of Adwa • Haitian independence • Ghanaian independence • Berlin Conference • Indian independence • Algerian independence • Madagascar independence.**

Self-check: A strong answer uses dates selectively, explains causation, compares cases and avoids treating all empires or all nationalist movements as identical.

78 Essay & Source Practice

Advanced preparation for written assessment

Essay questions

- 1. To what extent was economic interest the main cause of European imperialism after 1870?
- 2. "World War II was the decisive turning point in global decolonisation." Discuss.
- 3. Why was decolonisation more violent in some colonies than others?
- 4. Assess the importance of international pressure in the success of anti-colonial movements.
- 5. How far did colonial rule shape the political problems of newly independent states?

Source comparison task

Source A: an official colonial speech claiming that empire brings order, education and development.

Source B: a nationalist newspaper arguing that taxation, racial inequality and political exclusion make colonial rule illegitimate.

Task: Compare the perspectives. Explain how origin and purpose shape each source, then identify one type of evidence needed to test each claim.

Planning frame

Argument	Evidence	Counter-evidence	Judgement
Factor 1			
Factor 2			
Factor 3			

Do not write a list of events. A history essay must explain relationships between causes, turning points and consequences.

79 Answer & Marking Guide

Key points for self-correction

Review test — answer points

1. Colonialism = direct control of territory; imperialism = broader extension of power.
2. Direct rule uses colonial officials; indirect rule governs through selected local authorities.
3. Berlin set rules for recognition of colonial claims and effective occupation.
4. Taxes encouraged wage labour/cash crops and financed colonial administration.
5. Adwa preserved Ethiopian sovereignty and challenged assumptions of European military superiority.
6. Company rule ended; Crown rule began in 1858.

More answer points

7. Mandates placed former German/Ottoman territories under outside administration with a stated goal of eventual self-government.
8. War weakened European states, disrupted colonial authority and strengthened self-determination claims.
9. Many African colonies became independent in 1960.
10. Non-alignment sought independent foreign policy outside simple US/Soviet bloc control.

Marking extended answers

Reward accurate evidence, explicit comparison, causal explanation and a supported overall judgement.

Excellent

Precise evidence, clear argument, weighs factors, handles complexity.

Good

Accurate knowledge and explanation, some comparison and judgement.

Developing

Main facts present but mostly descriptive or weakly organised.

Needs work

Major factual gaps, unclear chronology, unsupported claims.

Teacher note: Accept alternative arguments when they are historically accurate and supported with specific evidence.

80 Master Reference Timeline

Key dates for rapid revision

1492	Columbus reaches Caribbean	1498	Vasco da Gama reaches India
1776	US independence declared	1804	Haiti independent
1830	French invasion of Algeria	1857	Uprising in India
1869	Suez Canal opens	1884-85	Berlin Conference
1896	Adwa; French annexation of Madagascar	1904-08	Herero and Nama genocide
1914-18	World War I	1919	Mandate era begins
1939-45	World War II	1945	UN founded; Asian independence claims
1947	India and Pakistan independent; Malagasy uprising	1949	Dutch recognise Indonesian sovereignty
1954	Dien Bien Phu; Algerian War begins	1955	Bandung Conference
1957	Ghana independent	1960	Madagascar, Congo and many African states independent
1962	Algeria independent	1963	Kenya independent; OAU founded
1975	Angola and Mozambique independent	1980	Zimbabwe independent
1990	Namibia independent		

Final synthesis

Colonisation reshaped sovereignty, economies, land, culture and political institutions across the world. Decolonisation dismantled formal imperial rule, but it did not erase these structures overnight. The best historical understanding therefore connects conquest, colonial administration, resistance, nationalism, world wars, international politics and the difficult work of building postcolonial states.

Final question: Which mattered more in ending empire: the weakening of imperial powers or the growing strength of anti-colonial movements? Use at least three regions in your answer.